GF-TADs activity report for the 15th Global Steering Committee meeting

Reporting period: January 2024–December 2024

Contents

Foreword

This report presents:

- The main activities of initiatives to control five main global priority transboundary animal diseases (TADs) since the meeting of the 14th Global Steering Committee (GSC14) in January 2024.
- A concise summary of the events carried out under the Global Framework for the Progressive Control of Transboundary Animal Diseases (GF-TADs) since GSC14 meeting.
- Follow-up on the recommendations of the action plan determined since GSC14.
- The main activities, at the global level, of the Management Committee and the Global Secretariat.
- The main activities, at the regional level, of the regional steering committees (RSC) and the regional secretariats (RS).

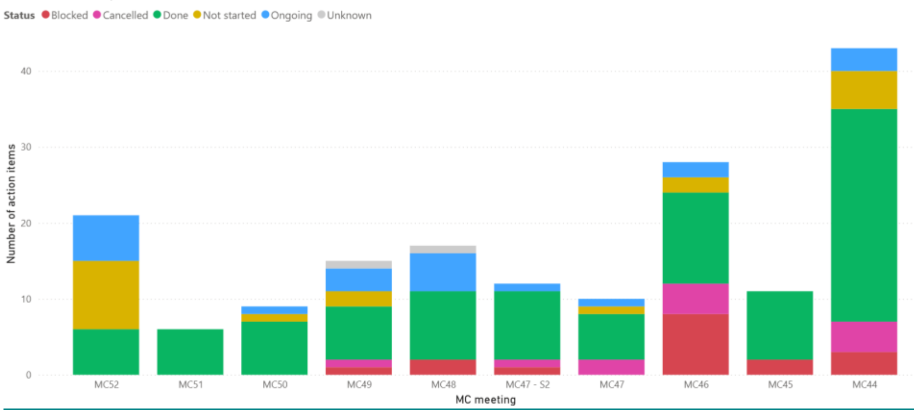
Governance activities

Management Committee

The GF-TADs Management Committee is the decision-making body of the GF-TADs for all final decisions regarding the GF-TADs initiative at global and regional levels. The Management Committee validates and follows recommendations provided by the Global Steering Committee where possible and appropriate in the overall strategy and financial possibilities. The Management Committee validates the work plan of the GF-TADs Global Secretariat, supervises the work of the Global Secretariat as guided by the Global Steering Committee (GSC) and reports on progress to the Global Steering Committee. Under the guidance of the Management Committee, the Global Secretariat coordinates the global activities of the GF-TADs and connects to all the governance bodies when necessary to strengthen collaboration between global and regional levels.

In 2024, Management Committee meetings were co-chaired by Dr Thanawat Tiensin, FAO Director Animal Production and Health Division (NSA) and Chief Veterinarian and Dr Jean-Philippe Dop, WOAH Deput Direactor General Institutional Affairs and Regional Activities. The Management Committee is composed of a WOAH delegation and an FAO delegation, both composed of three members (FAO: Dr Tiensin, Dr Dhingra, Dr Minjauw; WOAH: Dr Dop, Dr Arroyo, Dr Mapitse). The two co-chairs are also delegation leaders. The Global Secretariat prepares and moderates the Management Committee meetings.

In 2024, three Management Committee (MC) meetings took place (MC50 to MC52), including two in person meetings. The regularity of these interactions contributes to strengthen the relationship between FAO and WOAH management and provide guidance to disease groups and global secretariats on selected topics. During these meetings the MC reviewed progress in the implementation and development of TADs specific strategies, in particular HPAI and certain governance topics such as synergies across groups, resource mobilisation, development of shared workplan, development of the key performance indicators (KPIs) of the GF-TADs Strategy for 2021-2025, and certain regional level activities.~~,~~ Figure 1 depicts the state of action items on various topics, decided by the MC in their six previous meetings). ~~The follow up on the progress of implementation of the GF-TADs Strategy milestones as well as recommendations of the GSC13 meeting was performed by the MC. The MC and GSC members have permanently access to the dashboards of follow up of these recommendations, action items and milestones.~~



Global Secretariat

The GF-TADs Global Secretariat (GS, hosted at FAO HQs) works under the supervision of the Management Committee. All proposals by the Global Secretariat must be agreed upon by the Management Committee before being implemented. The Global Secretariat is currently composed of Bouda Vosough Ahmadi (global coordinator, FAO), Alexandre Fediaevsky (regional coordinator, WOAH) and Karima Ouali (global and regional disease expert, FAO). ~~Gian Mario Cosseddu and Yu Qiu (both disease control experts from FAO) supported the GS from January to November 2023.~~ The regular interactions between the GS team members generate a strong cohesion, mutual understanding, and team spirit that increase the efficiency of the coordination role of the GS at HQs and regional offices. The GS meets weekly and coordinates the day-to-day activities of the GF-TADs. The GS also supervises the global GF-TADs website and GF-TADs publications with the effective support of the communication teams at both organizations.

~~Follow up of previous~~ Global Steering Committee ~~GSC~~ and follow up of previous recommendations

The 14th Global Steering Committee was organised in three sessions on 30 April, 7 and 27 May 2024 to respectively 1) update participants on progresses achieved and challenges to address, 2) to reflect on strategic issues to improve the GF-TADs mechanism and 3) launch the HPAI global strategy and review recommendations.

[dashboar on updated recommendations to be added]

Regional governance activities

Africa, postponed the organisation of the Regional Steering Committee

Asia and the Pacific, organised a sub regional GF-TADs meeting for South Asia

Middle East, postponed the organisation of the Regional Steering Committee

Europe, organised the 11th Regional Steering Committee in person, in the margin of the WOAH Regional Conference for Europe (https://rr-europe.woah.org/en/Events/11th-meeting-of-the-regional-steering-committee-of-the-gf-tads-for-europe/) on 2 October 2024. The participants re-elected Dr Van Goethem as President and Drs Ulrich Herzog and Vasili Basiladze were elected as Vice-Presidents for the next four years, and Memebrship of the Steering committe. Permanent Secretariat functions will be ensured Dr Budimir Plavsic, WOAH Regional Representative. The meeting highlighted the continuing challenges of TAD in Europe and Central Asia and the need for coordinated, collaborative and innovative solutions within the GF-TAD framework. The commitment of organisations such as FAO and WOAH, together with the active participation of Member States and resource partners, is essential for effective disease prevention and control. The **new composition of the Regional Steering Committee for Europe** will be dedicated to continuing to improve the management of the GF-TADs mechanism in Europe, which has proven to be one of the examples of best practice at global level, in order to support Members and their veterinary services.

Americas organised a virtual regional Steering Committee meeting on 4 November (Elections of the GF-TADs Regional Steering Committee for the Americas - Americas) and elect Dr Koren Custer, USDA, as chair. The meeting was also an opportunity for the members of the committee to share their updates on the actions they are taking on the priority transboundary animal diseases for the region (highly pathogenic avian influenza, African swine fever, classical swine fever, new world screwworm and foot and mouth disease).

Partnership and Financing Panel (PFP)

KPIs of the GF-TADs Strategy for 2021-2025

Introduction

Indicators reflecting the impact of the GF-TADs Strategy

Objective 1: Establish strategies for priority TADs at sub-regional, regional and global level.

Output 1.1: Facilitate and coordinate TADs prioritization.

Output 1.2 Formulate regional and sub-regional TADs control strategies.

Output 1.3 Establish mechanisms for harmonized/coordinated planning

Objective 2: Develop and maintain capacities to prevent and control TADs

Output 2.1: Address capacity gaps identified and priorities for capacity building.

Output 2.2: Strengthen multi-disciplinary planning for the prevention and control of priority TADs.

Output 2.3: Provide harmonized mechanisms/tools to monitor the control of priority TADs.

Objective 3. Improve sustainability of strategies to control priority TADs through multi-disciplinary partnerships.

Output 3.1: Strengthen engagement and coordination with relevant stakeholders, including the private sector

Output 3.2: Improve advocacy skills for TADs control

Output 3.3: Promote sustainable funding mechanisms

GF-TADs Initiative for the global control of African swine fever (ASF), 2021–2025

Brief description of the Initiative

Following an appeal made at the 87th General Session of the World Assembly of Delegates of the World Organisation for Animal Health (WOAH), WOAH and the Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations (FAO) developed an Initiative for the global control of African swine fever (ASF) under the umbrella of the GF-TADs. This Global Initiative (GI), officially launched in January 2020 during the 85th International Green Week in Berlin, was publicly released in July 2020. The Initiative is published in the ASF section of the GF-TADs website, where information is regularly added and updated.

The goal of the Global Initiative is to achieve global control of ASF, which is defined as a combination of the following criteria:

- no new countries affected by ASF
- decline in the number of countries affected by ASF
- decline in the number of ASF outbreaks
- reduced losses due to ASF.

Three objectives are defined as preconditions for achieving global control of ASF:

1. Improve countries' capabilities to control (i.e. prevent, respond to and eradicate) ASF using WOAH standards and best practices that are based on the latest science.
2. Establish an effective coordination and cooperation framework for the global control of ASF.
3. Facilitate business continuity.

These objectives form the framework under which the outcomes and outputs are defined and the Operational Plan of activities is established.

The ASF Working Group

In July 2020, the GF-TADs ASF Working Group was formed to coordinate, monitor and evaluate the implementation of the Global Initiative, and to develop and support ASF control strategies at global and regional levels. The Working Group is composed of three members of the FAO and four members of WOAH, from the headquarters and regional offices of the two organisations, with a rotating chairmanship on an annual basis:

- WOAH: Gregorio Torres (chair), Viola Chemis, Charmaine Chng
- FAO: Andriy Rozstalnyy, Akiko Kamata, Yooni Oh

The Working Group is supported by the GF-TADs Global Secretariat and reports to the GF-TADs Management Committee. Strategic decisions are made in consultation with and under guidance from the GF-TADs Global Steering Committee. The progress of the Global Initiative is monitored through a dedicated monitoring and evaluation (M&E) framework that was developed with the support of M&E experts, assisted by an IT tool. The ASF Working Group convenes every other month and continues to support the implementation of ASF activities at the global and regional levels, including contributing to the work of the GF-TADs regional steering committees and the regional Standing Group of Experts (SGE) on ASF.

Epidemiological situation update

African swine fever is present and continues to spread in Africa, Europe, and Asia. In 2024, three countries reported the first occurrence of the disease: Montenegro in January, Albania in February and Sri Lanka in October. In addition, countries already affected reported the spread of the disease to new areas: Bhutan (May, June and July 2024), Côte d'Ivoire (March 2024), Germany (June and July 2024) and Poland (May 2024).

During the period from January 1 2024 to December 31 2024, 31 countries and territories reported information to the WOAH World Animal Health Information System (WAHIS) through immediate notifications or follow-up reports. These reports declared a total of 6,807 outbreaks (1,532 in domestic pigs and 5,275 in wildlife), 195,191 cases (187,398 in domestic pigs and 7,793 in wildlife), and 222,174 losses (dead animals and animals killed and disposed of) in domestic pigs.

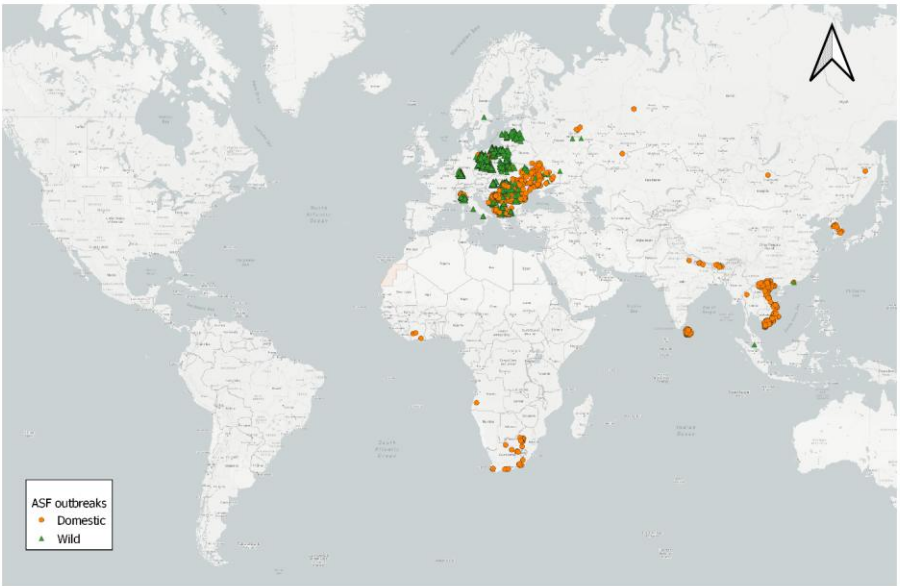


Figure 1. Global distribution of ASF outbreaks that started in 2024. Source: WOAH WAHIS

Progress in the last year

The ASF Global Initiative identifies support mechanisms to improve the capability of countries to control ASF, improve the coordination and cooperation of key stakeholders from the private and public sectors, and minimise the consequences of ASF through business continuity.

One of the key factors for sustainable control of ASF is the creation of an intelligence framework to share disease information effectively. The Standing Group of Experts on ASF (SGE-ASF) continue to be a relevant regional network to gather decision makers and experts able to coordinate regional efforts, share best practices, promote inter-sectoral cooperation, including private sector and thereby address the disease in a collaborative, transparent and harmonised way.

In June 2024, the 9th SGE-ASF Meeting for the Asia and the Pacific was held in-person in Makati, Philippines and was focused on risk communication and community engagement. In April 2024, the 22nd SGE-ASF Meeting for Europe was organised in Mecklenburg, Germany on the control of ASF in wild boar populations and in September 2024, the 23rd SGE-ASF Meeting for Europe was held in Ohrid, North Macedonia, with a focus on cross-border cooperation. In Africa, the 4th SGE-ASF meeting was held online, in October 2024, and focused on outbreak management.

To facilitate cooperation and dialogue across the SGE-ASF, the Global Coordination Committee for ASF (ASF GCC) was launched in May 2023, bringing together Chairs of the GF-TADs Regional Steering Committees and members of SGE-ASF where collectively, priority areas in-common were identified to guide future activities. In 2024, the second meeting of the ASF GCC was held on the margins of WOAH's 91st General Session to discuss technical priorities in the near future and the key strategic priorities of each region. ASF GCC identified the priority areas including the importance of continued global and regional coordination, early detection and surveillance, biosecurity, risk communications, monitoring of wild pig populations and vaccination.

FAO and WOAH, in collaboration with other stakeholders also implement their own ASF work programme contributing to the ASF GI. The GF-TADs mechanism, particularly the ASF Working Group, is effective to enhance coordination between the work programmes of the two organisations.

Highlight on WOAH activities contributing to ASF GI

- Strengthening laboratory diagnostics for ASF

WOAH continues to work closely with its network of seven ASF Reference Laboratories to harmonise, standardise, validate and make available ASF diagnostic assays; to provide expertise and training for WOAH and its Members in relation to ASF diagnosis, surveillance and control; and to collect, analyse and disseminate epidemiological information on the global occurrence of ASF and the genetic characterisation of ASF virus. In 2024, seven meetings were held to exchange scientific and technical expertise on ASF vaccine development, diagnosis, and control measures. The Network has been exploring ways to establish an open access information sharing platform for ASF virus genome sequence data. In addition, the Network released a manual on the protocols and guidelines for laboratory diagnosis of ASF.

- ASF notification and situation reports

WOAH monitors notifications of the occurrence of ASF through WAHIS and generates reports providing an update of the ASF situation at both global and regional levels. Situation reports for ASF are published periodically and are available online. The reports cover the updates on ASF occurrences and include other significant updates and key recommendations for Members.

- Standards on safe and efficacious ASF vaccines

In order to provide vaccine manufacturers and regulatory authorities with the minimum standards that the vaccines would have to comply with, in September 2023, the first draft standards on the manufacture of safe and efficacious vaccines for ASF were circulated by the Biological Standards Commission for Members. Through several rounds of circulation, the Biological Standards Commission addressed Member comments in collaboration with WOAH ASF Reference Laboratory Network. The draft chapter is expected to be adopted in May 2025.

- Technical support for the implementation of the regional and national strategies for the prevention and control of ASF

WOAH PVS Evaluation with ASF Specific Content methodology, which was developed by an *ad hoc* Group in September 2022 was piloted in October 2024.

- Guidelines on how to effectively manage risks at the wildlife-livestock interface

WOAH initiated a project to develop guidelines on how to effectively manage risks at the wildlife-livestock interface according to WOAH standards. The guidelines will cover a broad spectrum of diseases including ASF and help Members preserve animal health status of domestic subpopulations and ensure business continuity. The guidelines are intended to be published in 2025.

Highlight on FAO activities contributing to ASF GI (FAO to update)

FAO HQ and Regional Offices and WOAH Regional and Sub-Regional Representations co-organised or participated in several national and regional ASF meetings and workshops and projects in 2023, including the following:

- The revision of the Regional ASF Control Strategy is finalized and hand overed to AU-IBAR
- National risk-based control strategies for three countries in eastern Africa are developed
- GARA Gap analysis workshop in Uganda in February 2023 to discuss gaps in knowledge of ASF and identify projects and outcomes in the control of ASF in Africa, and subsequent meeting in November 2023 of the GARA Africa Chapter workshop/ General Assembly
- ASF Workshop in the Philippines for ASEAN in May 2023 to finalize the ASEAN ASF Prevention and Control Strategy, which was endorsed by the ASEAN Sectoral Working Group for Livestock
- Consultancy project for a risk-based ASF Control Strategy, piloted in one country in Southeast Asia
- Global ASF Research Alliance (GARA) Gap Analysis workshop in the Philippines in December 2023,

identifying critical knowledge and research gaps related to ASF which are specific to Asia
- Caribbean Agriculture Week with a focus on ASF in October 2023, with a commitment to prioritise ASF prevention and control, and strengthen surveillance for ASF in the Caribbean countries
- SGE-ASF expert mission to Bosnia and Herzegovina, in response to detection of ASF
- Launched a new virtual training course through VLC on ASF prevention, detection and control in resource-limited settings for east Africa
- Regional Simulation Exercise (SimEx) on African Swine Fever (ASF) Outbreak Investigation In Thailand in August 2023, to strengthen capacities of the national veterinary authorities to respond to ASF outbreak situations with simulated conditions
- Launched a new virtual course on ASF management in smallholder settings in September 2023 (https://virtual-learning-center.fao.org/mod/page/view.php?id=13158), the course was tailored to fit for the Asia-Pacific region
- Annual round for the swine disease proficiency testing programme for 2022 to 2023, in collaboration with the Australian Centre for Disease Preparedness was conducted by RAP. The proficiency testing programme for swine diseases was designed to assess the detection of swine diseases using PCR. For ASF testing, 24 out of 26 laboratories reported results which aligned correctly. Two laboratories reported a negative sample as indeterminate.
- To support smallholders in improving their community resilience to ASF, the Community ASF Biosecurity Interventions (CABI) was previously piloted in a community in the Philippines to protect against the spread of ASF through strengthening smallholder swine production biosecurity using a participatory approach in 2022. For 2023, CABI has further expanded in five countries such as Cambodia, Indonesia Lao PDR, Philippines, and Thailand. In 2023, main work was to update and polish the protocol by gathering all participating countries and target areas were selected.
- Multiple capacity development programme at the national and subnational levels to strengthen capacities of animal health officials

Funding for ASF

- The Global Initiative lists the various activities that are underway or are being planned under each objective of the Global Initiative in the Operational Plan available online in the GF-TADs website. The Operational Plan shows allocated funds and funding sources for each activity and funding gaps in view of efficient coordination. Activities that have identified donors are shown. Although the activities are coordinated under the Global Initiative, the management of the activities and the funds is under the responsibility of the relevant FAO or WOAH headquarters or regional offices.
- The following is a summary table of the funding available for activities related to ASF. It covers the past two years and the coming years.

Table 1. Funding to support activities related to ASF, by donor, amount, region and status or period of ending if any specified.

Source: GF-TADs ASF Working Group.

Organisation	Donor	Amount	Beneficiary Region	Status/Period
WOAH	Canada (CFIA-AAFC)	EUR 195,468.04	Global	open
	Canada (CFIA-AAFC)	EUR 249,363.54	Americas	open
	China (People's Republic of)	EUR 1,550,000	Asia Pacific; Global	open
	EU-DG SANTE	EUR 316,000	Europe; Global	open
	Italy	EUR 1,110,035.38	Global	open
	Japan	tbd	Asia Pacific	open

	USA-DTRA	EUR 1,300,000	Global	open
	Korea (Rep. of)	EUR 40,000	Asia Pacific	closed
	Italy	EUR 150,000	Global	closed
	USA-DTRA	USD 355,200	Global	closed
	USA-USDA	USD 500,000	Global	closed
FAO	Italy DoD DTRA (USA)	EUR 150,000	Global	Jul 2024
		US$ 371,800	Global	
		US$ 1,432,461	South East Asia	
	Korea (Republic of)	US$ 803,500	East Asia	21 Dec 24
	Korea (Republic of)	US$ 3,763,147	South East Asia	21 Dec 24
	USA BHA	US$ 1,600,000	South East Asia	31 Aug 2024
	FAO	US$ 500,000	Balkans	30 Nov 21
	FAO	US$ 500,000	Pacific Islands	21 Jan 23

Global Foot and Mouth Disease (FMD) Control Strategy

The GF-TADs FMD Working Group

The GF-TADs Foot and Mouth Disease Working Group (FMD-WG) is composed of three members from FAO, three members from WOAH and a representative from the European Commission for the Control of FMD (EuFMD).

The members of the FMD-WG in 2024 are:

- FAO: Melissa McLaws (co-chair), Madhur Dhingra and Muhammad Javed Arshed
- WOAH: Neo Mapitse (past co-chair replace by Min-Kyung Park from 1 September 2024), Bolortuya Purevsuren and Mohamed Sirdar (past member replaced by Caesar Lubaba from 8 October 2024)
- EuFMD: Fabrizio Rosso

Summary of the Strategy

The Global FMD Control Strategy, developed under the FAO–WOAH GF-TADs, was endorsed in 2012 for a 15-year period. The overall objectives of the Strategy are to alleviate poverty and improve livelihoods in developing countries, and to further protect the global and regional trade in animals and animal products. The specific objective is to improve FMD control in endemic regions, thereby protecting the advanced animal disease control status in other regions of the world.

Under the Strategy, countries work to reduce the burden and impact of FMD by building adequate laboratory and surveillance systems, strengthening veterinary service capacities, supporting quality-controlled vaccination programmes and creating possibilities to control other priority animal diseases through practical and cost-effective combinations of activities. The Strategy includes three components: (i) improving global FMD control, (ii) strengthening Veterinary Services and (iii) improving the prevention and control of other major diseases affecting livestock. Concerning the first component, 80 countries are engaged in implementing the Progressive Control Pathway for Foot and Mouth Disease (PCP-FMD) with the goal of reducing or eliminating FMD virus circulation by 2027. Other regions not overseen by the FMD Working Group are engaged in other regional initiatives, e.g. South-East Asia and China Foot and Mouth Disease (SEACFMD) and the South American Commission for the Fight against Foot-and-Mouth Disease (COSALFA).

The Global FMD Control Strategy emphasises a regional approach to exchanging information and experiences, to coordinating efforts and to developing regional roadmaps showing a country's ambitions and allowing regular progress assessment.

Epidemiological situation in the past two years

Foot and mouth disease continues to be widespread in many parts of the world. Globally, seven regional virus pools have been identified. Within these pools, similar viruses circulate and evolve. Countries within a pool will therefore have similar requirements for selecting appropriate vaccines. Periodically, viruses spread between pools and to new regions.

Pool 1 (East Asia): Serotypes O and A are endemic in Southeast Asia, with the O/ME-SA/Ind-2001e lineage dominant. The lineage has spread outside the core countries in Pool 1 to countries including Mongolia, Kazakhstan and Russia to the north, Indonesia (incursion in May 2022 and is now considered endemic after more than 30 years free of FMD). Serotype Asia-1 has rarely been detected since 1998, except for outbreaks in Vietnam (2007) and Myanmar (2017).

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Pool 2 (South Asia): Serotypes O, A and Asia-1 are circulating in South Asia. Over the past 5 years, the O/ME-SA/SA-2018 lineage has become increasingly dominant in India to now represent approximately 50% of serotype O FMD cases. Serotype A and serotype Asia-1 are also circulating in this pool.

Pool 3 (West Eurasia): Serotype SAT2 continues to circulate in this pool following its incursion in 2023. It was the first time SAT2 had been detected in most countries in the region, and therefore most livestock had no immunity due to either prior infection or vaccination. Serotypes O, A and Asia-1 are endemic in

West Eurasia. The predominant strains are A/ASIA/Iran-05 and O ME-SA PanAsia-2. The O/ME-SA/SA-2018 lineage has spread from Pool 2 to Pool 3 and has been detected in Iran, Palestine and Türkiye.

Pool 4 (East Africa and North Africa): Serotypes O, A, SAT1, SAT2 and SAT3 circulate in East Africa, with O/EA the predominant lineage. The AgResults FMD Vaccine Challenge project is ongoing to motivate vaccine producers to supply good-quality FMD vaccines for the East African market (see https://agresults.org/projects/fmd-vaccine).

In North Africa, whilst no outbreaks were reported in Tunisia, Algeria and Morocco between 1999 and 2013, FMD has been detected several times in the last nine years, possibly related to increased trans-Saharan connectivity with the construction of new roads. Most recently, O/EA3 has been detected in Tunisia, Algeria and Libya. Further, Serotype SAT2 topotype V was detected in Algeria in early 2024, with further outbreaks of this serotype reported in November 2024. This particular topotype was last detected in Togo and Cote d'Ivoire in 1990. The long period of time without detecting this specific topotype highlights the gaps in global FMD surveillance, which is particularly sparce in West and Central Africa.

Pool 5 (West Africa): Serotypes O, A, SAT1 and SAT2 circulate in this region, with serotype O believed to be predominant. FMD surveillance remains limited in this Pool, resulting in important knowledge gaps concerning circulating virus strains. Novel approaches such as using nucleic acid recovery from lateral-flow devices as well as RNA transfection methods to characterise the FMD viruses are available to fill gaps in surveillance, however, remain to be widely adopted.

Pool 6 (Southern Africa): Serotypes SAT1, SAT2 and SAT3 usually circulate in this region. However, since 2018, Serotype O/EA-2 has been increasingly detected, beginning in Zambia in 2018, with further detections in Namibia (2021), Malawi and Mozambique (2022). These are the first detections of serotype O in the region in approximately 20 years and warrants serious consideration as the livestock in these countries are largely naïve to the serotype and therefore the vaccine composition may need to be adapted. In South Africa, after having no new FMD outbreaks in 2023; there have been four reported outbreaks in 2024: Mpumalanga (SAT1/II – linked to buffalo), Kwazulu-Natal (SAT2/I), Eastern Cape (SAT2/I and SAT3/I). Importantly, these cases represent the first recorded FMD outbreaks in Eastern Cape.

Pool 7 (South America): Except for Venezuela, there have been no suspected cases of FMD in South America during 2020-2024. Bolivia and Brazil have ceased vaccination in their territories.

For further details, see:

1. WAHIS Reports
2. Quarterly FMD reports jointly published by the World Reference Laboratory for FMD (WRLFMD), FAO and EuFMD
3. country reports (Detection and Serotyping, Genotyping and Vaccine matching reports) produced the WRLFMD

Progress and challenges in the last year

Achievements

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- Promoting the Global Strategy

Following the external review of the implementation of the Strategy concluded in 2023, the FMD-WG met in person at FAO HQ to discuss the results and the way forward. Although progress had been made by the over 80 Members engaged in the PCP-FMD, the level of progress varied according to the Region. Common gaps and challenges identified included insufficient levels of resources, and surveillance capacity, poor vaccination coverage, inadequate livestock movement controls and insufficient awareness of the negative socioeconomic impacts of FMD and the benefits of control. Resource mobilisation is very weak and hinders progress particularly in the resource poor Members.

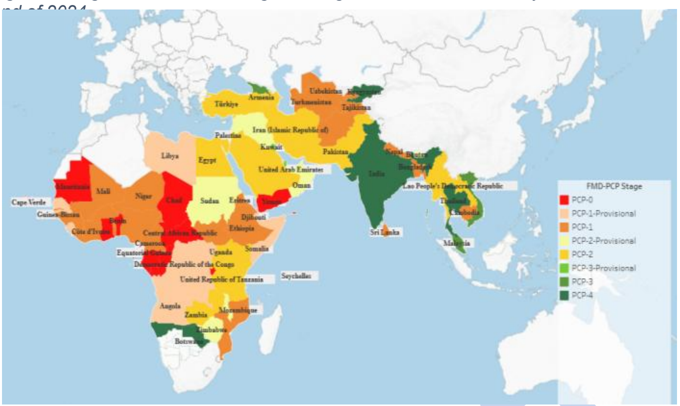
The meeting reflected on the outcomes of the external review of the Global FMD control strategy implementation. Discussions focused on how to improve the uptake of (or re-incentivize) the PCP-FMD at the country level, governance and stakeholder engagement at regional and global levels, the effectiveness of the FMD-WG and the overall impact of its activities. SWOT analysis of the Global FMD control strategy execution conducted to plan and prioritize future activities. Activities to the end of current strategy (up to 2027), and the next phase are considered. Follow-up actions/recommendations are developed.

Advancement along the PCP-FMD is hampered by the slow development of national FMD risk assessment plans and risk-based strategic plans. There is also a concern that national FMD control plans generally tend to be overly ambitious and not feasible to be fully implemented. To address these concerns, the FMD-WG is reviewing the PCP-FMD acceptance procedures for future improvements. It was noted that the PCP-FMD self-assessment tool (SATv2) is readily available for countries' use and provides a snapshot of the progress made along the expected outcomes of each stage of the PCP-FMD.

- Progression along the PCP-FMD and Official FMD recognition procedures

The PCP-FMD stages of countries at the end of 2024 are shown in Figure 2. In 2024, three countries (Cote d'Ivoire, Liberia and Togo) advanced to Stage 1. The countries' progression along the PCP-FMD stages is determined through the assessments of the outcomes of the country reports, interviews, questionnaires and the outputs from the PCP-FMD self-assessment tool. The PCP-FMD SAT (SATv2, updated version) is very useful for a continuous self-evaluation and prioritisation of the areas for improvement.

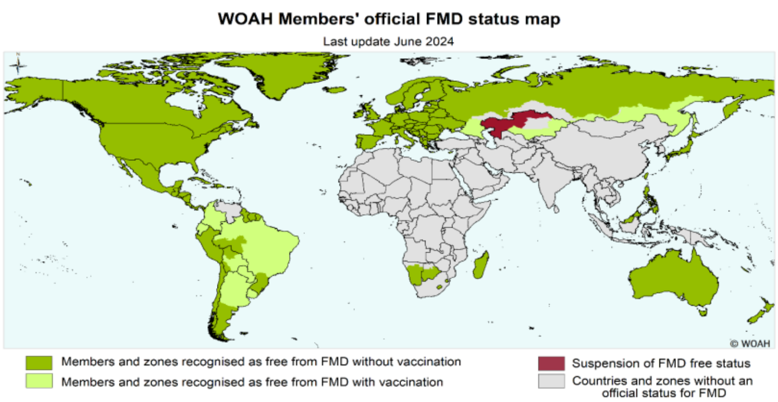
Figure 2 Stages of countries along the Progressive Control Pathway for FMD at the end of 2024



Source: UN. 2024. PCP-FMD dashboard available at https://www.gf-tads.org/fmd/progress-on-fmd-control-strategy/en/ consulted on 27 February 2025. The boundaries and names shown, and the designations used on this map do not imply the expression of any opinion whatsoever on the part of FAO concerning the legal status of any country, territory, city or area or of its authorities, or concerning the delimitation of its frontiers and boundaries. Dotted or dashed lines on maps represent approximate border lines for which there may not yet be full agreement.

Note: Data from GF-TADs FMD Working Group (Regional Advisory Group (RAG) assessment from the latest FMD Roadmap meetings), and National Authorities.

Figure 1~~3~~ Map of FMD official status at the end of 2024



Source: WOAH. 2025. Official disease status maps available at https://www.woah.org/en/disease/foot-and-mouth-disease/#ui-id-2 consulted on 27 February 2025.

Regarding official status recognition procedures, WOAH continued to provide training, standards and guidelines to Members regarding the requirements for official recognition and in 2024. Liechtenstein was added to the list of *countries or zones* free from FMD. No official FMD control programme was newly endorsed in 2024, and China's endorsement of its official control programme for FMD was withdrawn in February 2024. The countries or zones official FMD status as of January 2024 is shown in Figure 3 below. Botswana had the reinstatement of the FMD-free status of a previously established containment zone which had been established in March 2023. Further details about these countries and zones are publicly available on the WOAH FMD official status. In 2024, mechanisms have been put in place for the Members countries whose status is suspended, or control programmes withdrawn, to receive more support and guidance from the WOAH/FAO FMD working group.

- Meetings

In September 2024, a joint PCP-FMD Roadmap meeting was held for the Eastern Africa and Southern Africa Roadmaps, in Dar-es-Salaam, Tanzania. 23 out of 26 countries of the Eastern and Southern Africa FMD roadmaps attended the meeting in-person while two countries participated virtually. Representatives of regional organizations/communities (AUPANVAC, GALVmed, ILRI, OVI), private sector and resource partners also attended the meeting.

Participants in the meeting agreed upon conclusions and recommendations. The need for strengthened awareness and advocacy concerning the impact of FMD and benefit of control was emphasized to address the lack of resources. Vaccine procurement challenges and lack of surveillance to ensure effective and targeted control measures were also identified as key challenges. Event article published on FAO Animal Health website (Link here)

During 2-4 July 2024, A GF-TADs Regional Advisory Group Meeting on FMD and PPR West Eurasia Roadmap was organized in Baku, Azerbaijan (hybrid format). This meeting aimed to bring together the members of the FMD and PPR RAGs for West Eurasia region for experience sharing, and discussion with the some of the nonvoting members of the RAG to improve their functioning and utility for the region. The report of the meeting is available here.

Other

- PCP-FMD Support Officers (PSOs) are assigned to provide tailored assistance to countries. This support is in high demand, with 13 PSOs working with over 30 countries. A review of the PSO system has been conducted, and a proposal to enhance the impact and sustainability of the system by training new PSOs based in the regions where support is needed, under the mentorship of FMD experts was approved by the FMD WG. The Senior PSOs (EuFMD experts) have been consistently engaged in the technical revision of the plans/programmes submitted in 2024.
- The ongoing WOAH laboratory twinning projects on FMD between the Pirbright Institute (WRLFMD) and Kenya and Jordan, respectively aim to strengthen capacity on FMD diagnosis.
- Reviewed and improved core agenda of regional FMD roadmap meetings by removing time-consuming country presentations and making greater use of FMD Self-assessment Tool and other surveys (FMD situation and vaccination), focusing on technical panel discussions (risk, vaccine, resource mobilization) and developing SMART recommendations.
- Regular bi-weekly and monthly meetings of the FMD WG held to review the workplan and activities to implement the Global FMD Control strategy.

Challenges

The lack of financial resources has been reported regularly as a limiting factor in implementing FMD control activities, especially vaccine procurement. There is a lack of timely surveillance information in some regions, which hinders effective vaccination, as the vaccines must be matched to the circulating strains. The Veterinary Services in some countries may benefit from support to advocate for more resources and national prioritisation for FMD control. In addition, there is a high turnover of Veterinary Services personnel trained in the procedure for the official recognition of animal health status or endorsement of FMD control programmes by WOAH, and this creates a limitation on the applications for new status, requiring continued training, as often requested by Member countries.

FAO and WOAH conducted activities on their own contributing to the FMD Strategy, ensuring coordination between the two organisations thanks to the FMD WG.

Highlight on FAO activities contributing to the global FMD strategy

- The development of FMD control strategies for three regional roadmaps (East Africa, West Africa and Middle East) was initiated.

- Two virtual trainings (for Anglophone and Francophone countries) conducted for National PCP-FMD point of contacts (POC). 23 POCs from 11 countries in 7 regions/sub-regions (Eastern Africa, Central Africa, Middle East, North Africa, Southern Africa, South Asia/SAARC and Western Africa) were trained. The trainings aimed at enhancing the capacity of POCs to develop and execute effective FMD control strategies within their countries. POCs are instrumental in advancing the Global FMD Control Strategy, addressing challenges and filling knowledge gaps. FAO had called for participation through Chief Veterinary Officers, leading to significant interest and designation of POCs for both English and French language sessions from countries in PCP-FMD Stages 0 to 2. The main outcomes of the surveys are:
    - Evidence of familiarity with PCP-FMD observed
    - Written FMD control plans are considered relevant although there is generally poor implementation of these plans due to resource constraints and competing priorities
    - Regional disparities in the challenges to PCP-FMD implementation are observed
    - The RAG is considered an important body for PCP-FMD stage acceptance, but a less relevant role is perceived in providing guidance and advocacy for regional FMD control
    - General interest in convening regular roadmap meetings with interest for multi-disease events, particularly from the non-national stakeholder group
    - The survey outcomes will be used by the FMD-WG to plan future activities in the final phase of the Global FMD Strategy Implementation (up to 2027)

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- Two web-based surveys designed on Microsoft forms® in French and English, targeted separately for national PCP-FMD points of contacts (from countries in West Africa, Central Africa, Eastern Africa, Southern Africa, Near East, West Eurasia, and South Asia FMD roadmaps) and non-national stakeholders (GCC-FMD, FAO & WOAH regional and sub regional officers and other regional bodies 'representatives engaged in the delivery, or as observers of FMD roadmap meetings) to collect feedback on the implementation of the Global FMD Control Strategy, and especially on PCP-FMD implementation at the national level as the main tool for FMD control in endemic countries. A total of 62 national stakeholders and 10 non-national stakeholders took the survey. An FMD specific laboratory mapping tool (LMT-FMD) to assess the laboratory capacities for FMD diagnostics has been developed and piloted in four countries (Cote D'Ivoire, Mozambique, Nigeria, Zambia).
- Two Guideline documents were finalized: (i) Practical surveillance guidelines for the progressive control of foot-and-mouth disease and other transboundary animal diseases (Published) and (ii) A practical guide to economic analysis for FMD control (to be released in the first half of 2025).
- Field and lab support packages were initiated in nine beneficiary countries (Bahrain, Cote D'Ivoire, Ghana, Jordan, Mozambique, Nigeria, Tanzania, UAE, and Zambia) in three FMD roadmap regions (Middle East SADC, and West Africa) to strengthen national capacities for the control of FMD and other TADs. The support packages are out-come based and encourage cascading of knowledge (ToT approach).
- Supported three countries (Cote D'Ivoire, Jordan, Mozambique) to conduct FMD NSP sero-survey. Guidelines for conducting a serological survey to assess the distribution of FMDv in a population developed and shared with the beneficiary countries.
- Created a bilingual (EN & FR) PCP-FMD digital Hub page on FAO's VLC platform as part of the Global FMD Control Strategy. PCP-FMD Hub is dedicated to support PCP-FMD practitioners globally by providing access to valuable resources curated by the FMD Working Group, along with a collaborative learning network. The is a prototype not yet open access (expected to be open access by the early 2025).
- Collaborations with the WRLFMD have continued in 2024 through a regular agreement with the EuFMD to support the Network of FMD reference laboratories, assist shipment of samples for genomic characterization, publish on a quarterly basis the FMDV global laboratory reports, and to develop the genomic surveillance and antigen prioritisation dashboards made available through the 'Open-FMD portal'.
- VADEMOS-FMD, the stochastic model developed by the EuFMD to quantify and estimate future demand for FMD vaccines in countries engaged in the PCP-FMD was finalized.
- An engagement survey for the extended PSO network was performed by the EuFMD. There were 22 anglophone and 16 francophone respondents. The primary objectives identified for these

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- The EuFMD hosts open access eLearning courses on eufmdlearning.works that support learners to understand the PCP-FMD and the requirements for progression Learners have completed a total of 604 of these courses since the beginning of 2024, broken down as follows:
    - Introduction au plan d'évaluation des risques: 4
    - Introduction to the Official Control Programme: 118
    - Introduction to the Risk Assessment Plan: 169
    - Introduction to the Risk-Based Strategic Plan: 134
    - What is the Progressive Control Pathway: 179

Highlight on WOAH activities contributing to the FMD strategy

The regional approach to capacity building in the control of FMD follows the seven FMD virus pools but the dynamics of livestock movement and trade patterns increase the risk, spread and emergence of FMD serotypes O and SAT 2 into new geographical locations. WOAH, in collaboration with FAO, conducted regional coordination meetings with the following aims: to support Members in exchanging information regarding the FMD situation, to promote the effective utilisation of existing tools, including Terrestrial Code standards and guidelines to, among others, prevent further spread of serotype SAT 2, strengthen and revise national FMD control strategies and strengthen laboratory networks. The Regional Advisory Group for FMD and PPR for West Eurasia met in July, and the first presential (hybrid) meeting since the COVID pandemic took place in September for Southern and Eastern Africa.

The Southeast Asia, China and Mongolia Foot and Mouth Disease Campaign (SEACFMD) is implementing the 6th phase under the guidance of SEACFMD Roadmap 2021-2025. The 27th SEACFMD Sub-Commission met in person for the first time in September 2024 after the last physical meeting in Vietnam in 2018 and underwent a foresight exercise on the future of FMD situation in the region and to guide the development of the upcoming SEACFMD Roadmap 2026-2030. New roadmap will also take into consideration the fundings of the Evaluation of SEACFMD Campaign from 1997-2020 and the evaluation of the Global FMD Control strategy.

All the Members participating in the regional coordination meetings have applied the Self-Assessment Tool (PCP-FMD SAT) to assess their level of implementation of FMD measures. The PCP-FMD SAT is aligned with the PVS Pathway. In 2024, three Members of the Africa Region (Côte D'Ivoire, Togo and Liberia) advanced to PCP-FMD stage 1 upon the approval of their Risk Assessment Plans (RAP) by the Regional Advisory Group. The GF-TADs FMD Working Group also continues to innovate and simplify the process as well as provides technical recommendations on Members' submitted plans. The WOAH continued to provide training and guidelines to Members regarding the requirements for official recognition and, in 2024, Liechtenstein was added to the list of countries or zones free from FMD.

The WOAH continues to provide guidance to those Members whose status has been suspended or whose control programmes have been withdrawn on the standards and procedure for reinstatement of official status.The outcomes and recommendations of PVS mission reports were also used to identify areas where the countries should continue to strengthen the veterinary Services to control FMD and other TADs. Improvements of the levels attained in certain critical competencies of the PVS pathway supports FMD control. Public Private Partnerships (PPP) workshops, and other targeted capacity building programmes of the PVS pathway continue to support the strengthening of the VS.

WOAH continues financially support the annual meetings of the WOAH/FAO Reference Laboratory Network for FMD. The ongoing WOAH Laboratory Twinning projects between The Pirbright Institute, United Kingdom, and the FMD National Reference Laboratories of Kenya and Jordan aim at building enhanced diagnostic capacity for FMD. This initiative will enable more Members in the regions to access high-quality FMD diagnostic testing and technical expertise.

Publications

1. Metwally, S., Drewe, J.A., Ferrari, G., Gonzales, J.L., Mclaws, M., Salman, M. & Wagner, B. 2024. Practical surveillance guidelines for the progressive control of foot-and-mouth disease and other transboundary animal diseases. FAO Animal Production and Health Guidelines 36. Rome, FAO. https://doi.org/10.4060/cd2138en

2. Report of the 4th GF-TADs West Africa roadmap meeting for foot-and-mouth disease (virtual meeting), 13-14 December 2023 (Link here)
3. Report of the second GF-TADs Central Africa roadmap meeting for foot-and-mouth disease (virtual meeting), 27-29 September 2022 (Link here)
4. Report of the PPR Blueprint Consultation and FMD Roadmap meeting for Economic Cooperation Organisation (ECO)/West Eurasia countries, Baku, Azerbaijan, 25-27 April 2023 (Link here).
5. Report of the First South Asia transboundary animal diseases coordination meeting for peste des petits ruminants, foot-and-mouth disease and lumpy skin disease, Paro, Bhutan, 8-12 May 2023 (Link here).
6. FAO Alerts Countries in the Mediterranean Region to Enhance Preparedness for Foot-and-mouth Disease (Link here).
7. Report of the 3rd meeting of the Global Coordination Committee on Foot and Mouth Disease (link here)

Various PCP-FMD guidelines and supporting tools were developed, updated and shared with the members to facilitate their work and that of the Working Group, including templates for strategic plans as well as meeting reports. The resources are published on the GF-TADs website. Also, a dashboard to visualise PCP-FMD progression was updated.

Funding for FMD

FAO projects

Donor	Scope	Amount (USD)	Period covered
FAO	National (Uganda)	100,000	2023 - 2024
FAO	National (Venezuela)	200,000	2023 - 2024
Australia	National (Indonesia)	799,316	2023 - 2024
European Union	National (Uganda)	3,538,813	2020 - 2024
Pakistan	National (Pakistan)	42,793,584	2017 - 2024
FAO	National (Uganda)	100,000	2023-2025
FAO	National (Venezuela)	200,000	2023-2025
FAO	National (Bangladesh)	500,000	2024-2025
Defense Threat Reduction Agency	Multi-regional (Africa, Black Sea Basin, Middle East)	3,822,070	2020 - 2024
FAO	Sub-regional (Southern Africa)	500,000	2023-2024

Two countries were supported with FMD vaccine procurement by FAO.

In addition, 20 other projects (funded by FAO or partners) on TADs, animal health systems, food security etc implemented certain FMD related activities such as FMD simulation exercise, FMD surveillance, procurement of FMD vaccine or reagents.

EuFMD projects

- European Union-funded activities by the European Commission for the control of (GCP/GLO/1217/EC) aim at lower FMD risk in the European neighbourhood and better preparedness on EuFMD Member Nations ensuring a safer Europe from FMD and similar Transboundary animal diseases, enabling better trade conditions and higher food security prospects for European stakeholders in the livestock sector. The four years programme (2023-2027) included specific activities (800.000 Eur) to sustain the Global FMD control strategy and particularly for supporting an effective implementation of the PCP, for the provision of tailored assistance to countries, for supporting capacity development, for providing technical and operational assistance to the GF-TADs FMD WG and for the establishment of multistakeholder platforms on vaccine security. Since October 2024, activities above delivered under EuFMD programme were revised to ensure more focus on Europe and its neighbourhood.

WOAH activities

Resource Partners/ Donor	Project status	Target Region	Activities	FMD Project Budget EUR	Project end date
China (People's Rep. of.)	on-going	SEACFMD; Asia & Pacific; Global	- Studies - CD Lab and other - SEACFMD - Awareness (coms)	1,060,000	open
Japan-Trust Fund	on-going	Asia & Pacific	- Broad set of activities agreed with Japan MAFF	No fixed amount	rolling contribution
DTRA GF-TADs II	on-going	Global (Americas excluded)	- GF-TADs Strategy - Meetings - Awareness materials - Trainings	No fixed amount	04.08.2028
EU 2023-2025	on-going	Europe and Africa	Roadmaps, RAGs, Epi/Lab meetings in Europe, Africa and ME	168,000	31.12.2025
Germany BMZ OHRT	on-going	Namibia/SADC Cameroon/ECCAS	- Horizontal Capacity Building	800,000	31.12.2026
Italy V	on-going	Global and regional	- flexible	5,000	31.12.2025

Update: 12 March 2025

Peste des Petits Ruminants Global Eradication Programme (PPR GEP)

PPR Secretariat

The FAO-WOAH Joint Secretariat was established by FAO and WOAH in March 2016 to drive the peste des petits ruminants (PPR) eradication effort on a global scale and support countries in fighting the disease under GF-TADs. The Secretariat reports to the GF-TADs Management Committee for coordination with other GF-TADs initiatives. Currently, the PPR Secretariat is composed of three WOAH staff members and ten FAO staff members (and one support staff), all based in their respective organisations (except the Secretary, 2 interns and support staff based in FAO-HQ). Each FAO staff is assigned to coordinated activities in the region (s) where he (she) is based.

The Rome-based UN Agencies (FAO, IFAD and WFP) ambassadors and Permanent Representatives 'Friends of the PPR Global Eradication Programme' (GEP) established in 2018 have been advocating for the programme at all levels, including during governing body meetings. The PPR GEP Secretary has been liaising regularly with them for policy decisions. The Permanent Representative meeting was held on 10 December 2021, with six ministers invited to share their views on controlling PPR. The subsequently meet in November 2022 and April 2023. At their April meeting, among recommendations made, the following were highlighted: i) preparing a policy brief showing the link between PPR and other global agenda priorities, ii) liaising with FAO's Resource Mobilization Division (PSR) to prepare guidelines and support for effective resource mobilization options, approaches and tools including donor intelligence and agreement negotiation, and iii) Permanent Representatives undertaking field missions to assess the implementation of PPR GEP preferably during ongoing vaccination campaigns.

The work of the Secretariat is supported by two governance structures, namely the PPR Advisory Committee, established in 2017 (meeting once per year), which provides strategic guidance and recommendations to the PPR Secretariat, and the PPR Global Research and Expertise Network (PPR-GREN also meeting once per year), which met for the first time in 2018 and been meeting yearly. The last meetings were on 7–9 December 2022 at CIRAD and NEVI India in 28-30 November 2023. The GREN serves as a forum for scientific and technical consultation, debates and discussions about PPR, encouraging innovation and supporting the PPR GEP. In line with the PPR GEP Blueprint approved in November 2022, the fifth GREN thematic group on episystem was established in 2023. The GREN has almost 320 members divided in 5 thematic groups: vaccination, wildlife, atypical species, socio-economy and episystem.

Brief description of the strategy

The PPR Global Control and Eradication Strategy (PPR GCES) was endorsed at the International Conference for the Control and Eradication of PPR organised by FAO and WOAH in Abidjan, Côte d'Ivoire in April 2015. The three components of the PPR GCES are: (i) the eradication of PPR globally by 2030, (ii) the strengthening of Veterinary Services and (iii) the control of other small ruminant diseases prioritised by stakeholders.

The overarching PPR GCES at the national level is based on four stages that combine decreasing levels of epidemiological risk with increasing levels of prevention and control. In Stage 1, the epidemiological situation is assessed. In Stage 2, control activities, including vaccination, are implemented. PPR is eradicated at Stage 3. In Stage 4, vaccination is suspended; the country must provide evidence that no virus is circulating at the zonal or national level and that it is ready to apply to WOAH for official recognition of its PPR-free status.

Figure 3. Progressive PPR control and eradication – the four stages of the PPR GCES. Source: FAO, OIE. 2015. Global Strategy for the Control and Eradication of PPR. Rome, FAO. http://www.fao.org/3/i4460e/I4460E.pdf

To implement the strategy, the first five-year PPR Global Eradication Programme (PPR GEP) was launched in 2017. The GEP is a multi-country, multi-stage process that implements the GCES. The four stages it sets out in GCES involve assessment, control, eradication and maintenance of PPR-free status. Regardless of the stage in which a country is initially placed, it will be supported to achieve the capacity it needs for each of the five key elements of PPR prevention and control, namely the diagnostic system, surveillance system, prevention and control system, legal framework and stakeholder involvement. Putting these five elements in place will enable any country to move with confidence to the next stage of control and eradication.

To categorise a country within these four stages, the PPR Monitoring and Assessment Tool (PMAT), a companion tool of the PPR GCES, is used. It measures activities and their impacts at each stage by requiring countries to input epidemiological and activities-based evidence, which it converts into guidance and milestones.

Epidemiological situation

Currently, 59 countries, plus one zone, are officially recognised as PPR-free; 67 are infected, and 71 have not reported PPR. Between 2015 and 2019, 12,757 outbreaks were reported to WOAH by 59 countries. By 2020, this number had shown a marked decrease. For example, 21 of the 67 infected countries have had no reported PPR outbreaks for more than 24 months, and 10 of these have had no outbreaks between 2015 and 2019. The conclusion is that control measures have had a significant positive impact. Figure 4 shows the current PPR distribution, with each country's position according to PMAT and WOAH official recognition. Since 2015, many countries have moved from Stage 1 to Stage 2 or 3.

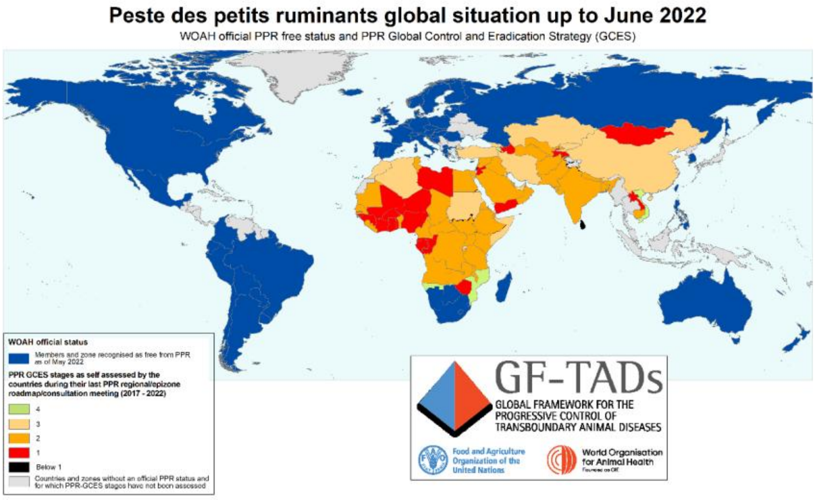

Figure 4. The PPR global situation with respect to the GCES stepwise approach, as reported by countries during roadmap meetings up to June 2022 (source: https://www.gf-tads.org/resources/publication-detail/en/c/1156005/).

Highlight on FAO WOAH joint activities contributing to PPR Strategy

Global level activities

The 7th meeting of the PPR Global Research and Expertise Network (PPR GREN) was held on 20 –22 January 2024, hosted by ADAFSA at Abu Dhabi, UAE. The meeting emphasised the need for research innovations to contribute to the eradication phase of the PPR Global Eradication Programme (PPR GEP). The meeting brought together approximately 80 in-person attendees as well as about 60 online participants. 30 scientific presentations were given, which covered the following overarching topics:

- Atypical hosts and wildlife: Role in PPR epidemiology, role as sentinels in surveillance and diagnostics of PPR in these species
- Diagnostics and surveillance: diagnostics for early detection and proof of disease freedom, surveillance systems and use of environmental samples for PPR detection
- Disease prediction/modelling/molecular epidemiology/Episystem approach: mathematical modelling to support PPR eradication, molecular epidemiology and genomic analysis of PPR outbreaks, livestock mobility and expert knowledge for PPR risk mapping
- Vaccine and vaccination: Thermotolerant vaccines, new generation vaccines, DIVA vaccines, combination vaccines, post-vaccinal evaluation
- Participatory approaches and Socioeconomics: Insights from the LIDISKI project in Nigeria and Eco-PPR project in West Africa, cost-benefit analysis of PPR Vaccination and partial budget analysis of PPR vaccination

The GREN meeting conclusions included investigations of the suitability of different vaccination strategies in different contexts, development of field-validated DIVA vaccines, further refinement of already developed DIVA vaccines, development of DIVA tests, validation of ELISA-tests for atypical and wildlife species, transmission dynamics and atypical/wildlife host susceptibility, development of surveillance strategies and collection of data from atypical and wildlife hosts including genomics, PPR risk mapping of wildlife populations, generation of socio-economic data of relevance to PPR (especially focusing on women and youth) and different vaccination strategies, determining willingness-to-pay for PPR vaccination, study of economic drivers for animal mobility, episystem delineation (using data on animal movement, densities, socio-economics and others).

The PPR AC was held on 27-28 June 2024, preceded by a PPR mini GREN (vaccination thematic group) and PPR AC meeting () 01-02/12/2023 and the recommendations were presented to the GF-TAD MC and focussed on: i) advocacy for the PPR GEP, ii) resource mobilisation, iii) PPR strategic plans at national and regional level aligned to PPR GEP BP; iv) research, v) Vaccination Strategy, vi) the need to identify likely technical challenges to be addressed in immediate future for the successful implementation of the PPR GEP BP

- Preparation of EU project for PPR eradication in Africa

The Action fiche for the EU project for PPR eradication in Africa was jointly prepared by FAO/IBAR/PANVAC/WOAH. The modus operandi for pan-Africa secretariat (PAS) was drafted by IBAR and inputs were provided by FAO and WOAH. Using the EU project, An EU multi-partner agreement will be signed by the AUC/EU/FAO/WOAH. Based on comparative advantages of each institution, specific budget has been allocated to that institution. FAO and WOAH will second respectively an epidemiologist and animal health specialist to PAS. PANVAC to second a laboratory specialist and IBAR the coordinator. The first phase of the project agreement was signed between AU-IBAR and EU, later followed by bilateral agreemnst between AU-IBAR and FAO & WOAH respectively.Inter-REC meetings were held in April and December 2024. These according to AU-IBAR are institutionalized meetings that will be organized regulary to enhance coordination in implementation of the PPR continental program.

Highlight on FAO activities contributing to PPR Strategy

SUREVEILLANCE, INTELLIGENCE, NETWORK, PREPARADNESS

Under this, many activities were implemented:

1. Successfully established a robust network of national epidemiology and laboratory coordinators, enhancing regional collaboration and strategic alignment in the PPR control
2. Mapped PPR infections and implemented surveillance and strategic planning for controlling PPR in Jordan and Egypt
3. Strengthened the veterinary service of the veterinary authorities by capacity building in PMAT and in building the countries National Strategic Plans (NSPs). This was done through hiring national consultant and technical support from the PPR secretariat
4. ToRs for National Consultancies on PPR risk mapping shared with 8 ECOWAS countries, 1 commenced, 2 approved, the rest yet to start implementation
5. Organized and facilitated South Asian TAD Regional Roadmap meeting at Paro, Bhutan, March 2023
6. Assisted countries to undertake PMAT self-assessment (ongoing)
7. Contributed to the training of RAG members and assisted in work plan development
8. Facilitated dossier preparation for PPR historically free countries (ongoing) in collaboration with FAOSFS (Ongoing)
9. Led organization and implementation of virtual Training workshop for North Africa on PPR surveillance and episystems to enable disease detection, control and eradication (45 participants from 6 countries).

10. Provided training to build capacities on surveillance & control at wildlife-livestock interface (REU, WA, SAARC).
11. Assisted Sri Lanka for sero-surveillance for dossier preparation, more than 3000 serum samples collected
12. Helped in planning field surveillance in Bhutan for dossier preparation,
13. Working closely with WCS and IAEA for controlling PPR at the livestock-wildlife interface in Mongolia. Samples were recently collected and send to IAEA for analysis.
14. Established and facilitated network of PPR national coordinators, epidemiology and laboratory networks to enhance regional collaboration and strategic alignment in PPR control.
15. Conducted virtual monthly meetings in each for updates on their PPR national strategic plans implementation activities.

LAB CAPACITY BUILDING AND NETWORKS

Capacity building and technology transfer was carried out for ELISA, PCR, Real time PCR, Multiplex PCR and LFD. In collaboration with the Joint FAO/IAEA Centre, for 39 countries with more than 100 participants trained. In 2022, PPR proficiency testing (PT) was carried out in 31 countries for 34 laboratories. In 2023, PPR PT was carried out in 37 countries for 39 laboratories. Other activities implemented are:

1. Organized virtual trainings on laboratory, epidemiology and vaccine implementation consultative meetings for Pakistan, Nepal, Bhutan, Bangladesh and Sri Lanka
2. Laboratory training and serosurvey sample analysis was done in Cape Verde for Dossier preparation and being planned the same for Sri Lanka
3. Laboratory Monitoring tool (LMT) for PPR was developed and piloted in 5 countries.
4. Facilitated a specialized workshop on laboratory methods for PPR diagnosis, leading to improved disease surveillance and response capabilities across national veterinary services in the SAARC rregion
5. Organized and facilitated Epidemiology and laboratory network consultative meetings in 5 regions,
6. Organized Laboratory capacity development training (Tanzania) for national staff.
7. Strengthened diagnostic capacities by implementing practical training in Jordan for 4 different Middle Eastern countries. The private sector was included in this training.
8. 25-diagnostic ELISA kits were procured and assisted in mapping the PPR distribution in 14 countries with 40,000 samples collected and analyzed.
9. Strengthened the diagnostic capacities of veterinary authorities by providing needed diagnostic kits and technical support

Studies, guidelines/tools/manuals production and implementation

Through European Commission support, and via the World Food Forum Transformative Research Challenge, 12 out of 83 applicants were awarded the PPR Special Prize in 2022, and 6 out of 34 applicants were awarded the prize in 2023. All the winners are either MSc or PhD students working on various research topics pertinent to the PPR GEP. The winners have the opportunity to present their research during the monthly PPR Stakeholder seminars as well as during the annual GREN meeting. They are also mentored by the Secretariat jointly with research institutions.

Using it 10 staff as well as almost 30 national consultants recruited in 08 regions, countries have been assisted for updating their NSP in line with PPR GEP Blueprint. These assisted implementing thet following:

1. Development of Guidelines and templates (NSP, regional strategy, National PPR Contingency Plan, PPR mainstreaming guide, communication strategic plan, PPR national surveillance plan, vaccination, episystem among other) as well as manuals,

2. Coordinated PMAT e-learning and digitization
3. Coordinated the revision of the Regional PPR Strategy for North Africa and organized a validation workshop on the strategy and its presentation at the REMESA meeting.
4. Assisted countries in updating their NSP in line with PPR GEP Blueprint
5. Assisted (technical backstopping) countries to undertake PMAT self-assessment(ongoing).
6. A Field Manual was produced for the PPR Diagnosis and currently under review

VACCINE PRODUCTION AND QUALITY CONTROL

1. Establish a network of vaccine producers to monitor meetings recommendations and vaccines procurement.
2. Convince Georgia to stop the vaccination and move to verification for freedom Approximately 80,000,000 animals were vaccinated between 2022/23 from FAO projects.
3. A PPR vaccine seed virus were provided to countries to replace the contaminated seed virus.
4. Followed-up with PAAVAC and vaccine producers for thermotolerant vaccines production and testing. Similarly followed with ILRI and IFAD for field testing of thermotolerant vaccines
5. Publication in Nature Reports and Vaccine collaborating with GALVMED, RVC, IAEA, Pirbright and CIRAD on validation of Diagnostics for atypical species and liquid stabilised vaccine in sheep and goats.
6. Assisted Pakistan through FAO funding for the procurement of vaccine seed virus from CIRAD

COMMUNICATION FOR DEVELOPMENT AND CROSS BORDER HARMONIZATION

A cross border harmonisation (episystem) workshop, organised by FAO, for PPR eradication in Western Africa and Regional Advisory Group were held on 6th – 8th November 2023, in Grand Bassam, Cote d'Ivoire. The meeting brought together representatives from countries sharing the Mano River basin and RAG members of Western Africa Region. Ambassador Seydou Cisse, Permanent Representative of Cote d'Ivoire for the Rome-based UN agencies, ECOWAS and WOAH staff were also in attendance. The objective of the meeting was to facilitate countries sharing borders in the Mano River Basin engage in action-oriented discussions about managing risks considering that the PPR *Global Eradication Programm*e (GEP) recognise the transboundary nature of PPR and emphasise the importance of consideration of potential incursion, distribution and risk pathways at the national level or within shared epidemiological patterns and disease drivers, referred to as an *episystem*. A RAG meeting was held on the sidelines of the cross-border meeting to support RAG members understand their role and agree on next steps of action to ensure the RAG is functional. After this meeting Ambassador Cisse and FAO held a meeting with the *African Development Bank* (AfDB) in Abidjan to assess possible resources to support the PPR GEP.

Conducted a regional cross-border harmonization training workshops in 4 regions that significantly elevated the proficiency in dossier preparation, contributing to the international recognition of Peste des Petits ruminants (PPR) freedom in the region

PPR leaflets were developed to educate farmers and stakeholders on the clinical signs of PPR, as well as on prevention and control measures.

Coordinated and collaborated with the AU-IBAR, CEBEVIRHA and IGAD-ICPALD on PPR GEP for the implementation of MoU on cross-border harmonization

Trained ECOWAS RAG members on their roles and responsibilities and facilitated the election of new RAG and organized first South Asian Regional Advisory Group (RAG) virtual meeting

RESOURSE MOBILIZATION AND ADVOCACY

Each year since 2019, a special issue of a peer-reviewed journal has been dedicated to PPR research. In 2019, the journal was *Frontiers in Veterinary Science*, in 2020 *Viruses*, in 2021 *Animals* and in 2022/23 *Viruses. Secretariat being the guest editors.*

Through partnerships with institutions, major accomplishments were achieved including:

Strong partnership with the African Union - Inter-African Bureau of Animal Resources (AU-IBAR) underpinned the development and launch of the Pan African PPR Eradication Programme (2022-2027).

The collaboration with the African Union Pan African Veterinary Vaccine Centre (AUPANVAC) is to assess and develop standardized criteria for thermotolerant PPR vaccines.

The Wildlife Conservation Society (WCS) was capacitated to mitigate the threat of PPR to wildlife: FAO-WOAH Guidelines for the Control and Prevention of PPR in wildlife populations are now available in all six official UN languages and Mongolian, and a Practical Guide for monitoring PPR in wildlife has been developed by WCS and FAO.

The PPR mainstreaming guide to support resource mobilization has been piloted in few countries and will be validated during the next advisory committee meeting in June 2024.

• Visit or discussion with resources partner:

African Development Bank:

Islamic Development Bank: organize side event during IsDB governing body meeting and involve on Bank activities

Bill and Melinda Gate Foundation: discussion in September 2023 with JJ Soula (WOAH), mission plan to Seattle,

US-APHIS: can support in the short term or seconding a part-time staff to the Secretariat

IFAD: Ambassador Cisse send a letter for follow-up of the 41st IFAD PPR side event meeting recommendations

World Bank: currently supporting PRAPS and suggestion to organize a meeting to understand weaknesses of surveillance and vaccination

European Community: IBAR grant of Euro 8M under negotiation

Highlight on WOAH activities contributing to PPR Strategy

Support to regional strategy

In addition to activities conducted jointly with FAO, regional coordination meetings were organised by WOAH for East Asia countries as a side event of a CVO forum meeting, and for South East Asia, not covered by a road map, leading to ASEAN PPR preparedness strategy.

WOAH also organised the technical item on PPR during the 25th regional conference for Africa leading to specific recommendations, taken into account to develop a joint programme for sub-Saharan African countries with AU IBAR, AU PANVAC and FAO starting from 2024.

A PPR and CBPP coordination meeting was held in Chad from 3 - 5 October 2023. The meeting brought together CVOs, veterinary delegates from neighbouring regions, private veterinarians, directors of veterinary laboratories, representatives of farmers' organisations from Cameroon, Central African Republic, Chad and Niger, as well as representatives of WOAH and regional animal health centres in ECOWAS and ECCAS. That coordination meeting is in line with the PPR *Global Control and Eradication Strategy* (PPR GCES) guidelines which strongly recommend that these states adopt a sub-regional and cross-border approach to the control and eradication of emerging and re-emerging animal diseases such as PPR. The meeting aimed at discussing national strategic plans for controlling CBPP and eradicating PPR in the respective countries, providing information on the numbers of animals vaccinated against CBPP and PPR, respectively during the recent campaigns, programming the number of animals to be vaccinated against CBPP and PPR for the next campaigns, planning and harmonising vaccination programmes against CBPP and PPR between the concerned countries, adopting a mechanism to ensure the continuity of meetings to coordinate joint vaccination campaigns at border level, strengthening and consolidating contacts between the veterinary authorities of these countries for any other TADs.

Strengthening laboratory diagnostics for PPR

The WOAH Reference Laboratory network for PPR managed by the three WOAH Reference Laboratories (CIRAD, the French agricultural research and co-operation organisation; The Pirbright Institute [United Kingdom]; and the China Animal Health and Epidemiology Center [People's Republic of China]) and composed of 21 laboratories, continued its support activities, which included organisation of proficiency testing with over 40 participants, and webinars (e.g. a webinar on Harmonisation of PPR diagnostic practices through proficiency tests and the third WOAH PPR Reference Laboratories network workshop) as well as keeping Members updated through the annual newsletter.

A laboratory twinning project was completed; three countries, Morocco, Senegal and Tanzania, benefited from this programme.

Other capacity building activities

Regional/epizone meetings provided opportunities to support Members with their PPR control activities and to assess and document Members' progression along the four -stage process towards PPR eradication. By the end of 2023, a total of 13 PVS missions with a PPR-specific component had been conducted; in 2023, this activity was conducted in Zambia. The PVS reports link to the PPR Monitoring and Assessment Tool (PMAT) as it provides objective field verification of PMAT staging with targeted recommendations that feed into the National Strategic Plans (NSPs). WOAH will continue to support Members with elaborating their PPR control and eradication plans and provide training on WOAH procedures for official recognition of PPR free status and for the endorsement of official PPR control programmes.

Following the finalisation of the revised PMAT (PMAT2), FAO and WOAH in 2023 initiated the development of e-module training to assist Members in the efficient use of the tool, which will enable them to monitor and evaluate the status of their PPR control and eradication activities and their progress along the stages of the PPR GCES. In addition, the development of a digital version of the PMAT was initiated to help users at country level to run the assessment as a collective exercise and facilitate PMAT submission and assessment by the Regional Advisory Groups (RAGs); for users at the Global and Regional GF-TADs Secretariat, the digital PMAT will provide an overview of common gaps and priorities for Members to address.

The Regional Sahel Pastoralism Support Project (PRAPS) continued to provide technical support to its beneficiary Members in the Sahel. The PRAPS project is supporting the implementation of PPR national strategic plans in the beneficiary Members. The project also assisted a few other countries in West Africa (Benin, Togo and Côte d'Ivoire) in the development of their PPR eradication programmes. As a result, PRAPS countries and Benin, Togo and Côte d'Ivoire are progressing well with their PPR control programme.

WOAH encourages Members that have never reported PPR to implement the required surveillance and other necessary activities to ensure compliance with the relevant WOAH standards with regard to official PPR free status and subsequently undertake the procedures for submission of an application to WOAH for the official recognition of their PPR free status. FAO and AU-IBAR have expressed their willingness to assist Members in this regard.

OHRT[1] TADs and PC-TADs[2] projects, funded by BMZ[3] , covering Cameroon, Namibia, Kenya and Ethiopia are ongoing and, in the case of Kenya, they are helping to strengthen the veterinary workforce and implement the PPR vaccination campaign.

Commented [N7]: OHRT and PC-TADs are two projects funded by BMZ. However, I can find no reference to a separate “BMZ TADs” project. Suggestion: “The BMZ-funded OHRT and PC-TADs projects” (retaining the footnote definitions)

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Support to vaccine access

The WOAH PPR vaccine bank has continued to give Members the opportunity to access, at a negotiated price, quality vaccines in accordance with an international procurement procedure. In 2023, 25 million doses of PPR vaccine were delivered through the WOAH PPR vaccine bank.

Publications

In 2022, *Peste des Petits Ruminants Global Eradication Programme II & III: Overview of the plan of action: Together for Peste des Petits Ruminants Global Eradication by 2030* was published by Blueprint, FAO; World Organisation for Animal Health (WOAH) (founded as OIE).

In 2021, *Guidelines for the Control and Prevention of Peste des Petits Ruminants (PPR) in Wildlife Populations*, drafted by the WOAH Working Group on Wildlife and the PPR GREN in collaboration with the PPR Secretariat, were published on the FAO and WOAH websites.

Each year since 2019, a special issue of a peer-reviewed journal has been dedicated to PPR. In 2019, the journal was *Frontiers in Veterinary Science*, and in 2020, *Virus*. In 2021, *Animals* was selected for the special issue on ‘Peste des Petits Ruminants: Five Years Implementation of Its Global Eradication Programme’. Currently, eight papers have been published. Also, a PPR special prize was established by FAO at the World Food Forum Transformative Challenge, with 12 winners in 2022. The prize is to support MSc and PhD students in collecting data for their theses.

Funding for PPR

FAO

France (2017–2020; US$ 330,891), DTRA (2019–2023; US$ 2,384,926), EC (Euro 2,500,000) FAO regular funds and several trust funds at the country level. IAEA with almost 10 projects with PPR component.

WOAH

DTRA (2019–2022; US$ 600,000; geographical scope: global), World Bank Regional Sahel Pastoralism Support Project (2015–2021; US$ 3,140,060 to ensure the regional coordination of the animal health component; geographical scope: Sahel), German Federal Ministry of Economic Cooperation and Development (2020–2024; EUR 2,500,000; geographical scope: East Africa), EU-DG SANTE (2019–2020;

[1] OHRT: One Health approach towards Rabies and Transboundary Diseases control
[2] PC-TAD: Prevention and Control of Transboundary Animal Diseases for the benefit of smallholder farmers
[3] BMZ: German Ministry of Economic Cooperation and Development

EUR 80,000; geographical scope: global), Italy (December 2021; EUR 150,000; geographical scope: global).

- Note: The World Bank funded Regional Sahel Pastoralism Support Project launched in 2015 (2015–2021; US$ 248 million; geographical scope: Sahel) is currently under negotiation for a second phase for 2022–2027..

Rinderpest post-eradication

The FAO–WOAH Rinderpest Secretariat

Muhammad Javed Arshed (FAO), Mariana Marrana (WOAH), Yu Qiu (FAO)

Summary of the strategy

Following the declaration of global freedom from rinderpest in 2011, Members entrusted FAO and WOAH to implement measures to maintain rinderpest global freedom. The FAO–WOAH Rinderpest Secretariat and the Rinderpest Joint Advisory Committee (JAC) were established in 2012 to coordinate a post-eradication strategy and mitigate the risk posed by the release of rinderpest virus-containing material (RVCM) from laboratories.

Post-eradication priorities:

- Establish and monitor FAO–WOAH Rinderpest Holding Facilities (RHFs) for safe storage of the remaining RVCM stocks;
- Implement the Global Rinderpest Action Plan and keep it up to date;
- Continue to advocate for destruction and sequestration of RVCM in the remaining countries, the reduction of RVCM holdings in RHFs and the number of Category A RHFs, while keeping the RHF network active;
- Maintain a global inventory of RVCM stored in and outside RHFs;
- Expand vaccine reserves and maintain diagnostic capacity;
- Approve essential research projects relevant to the post-eradication era;
- Ensure the existence of adequate surveillance systems and follow-up on suspect cases;
- Communicate and advocate to strengthen awareness of rinderpest and the impacts of re-emergence of the disease and ensure that the communication tools remain available.

Epidemiological situation

The last case of rinderpest in the field was reported in Kenya in 2001. The disease was declared eradicated in 2011. In 2012, 36 countries were storing RVCM. As of December 2024, RVCM was kept in five countries outside RHFs and in six countries in designated RHFs. Genetic sequences of RPV are available to the public in databases such as GenBank.

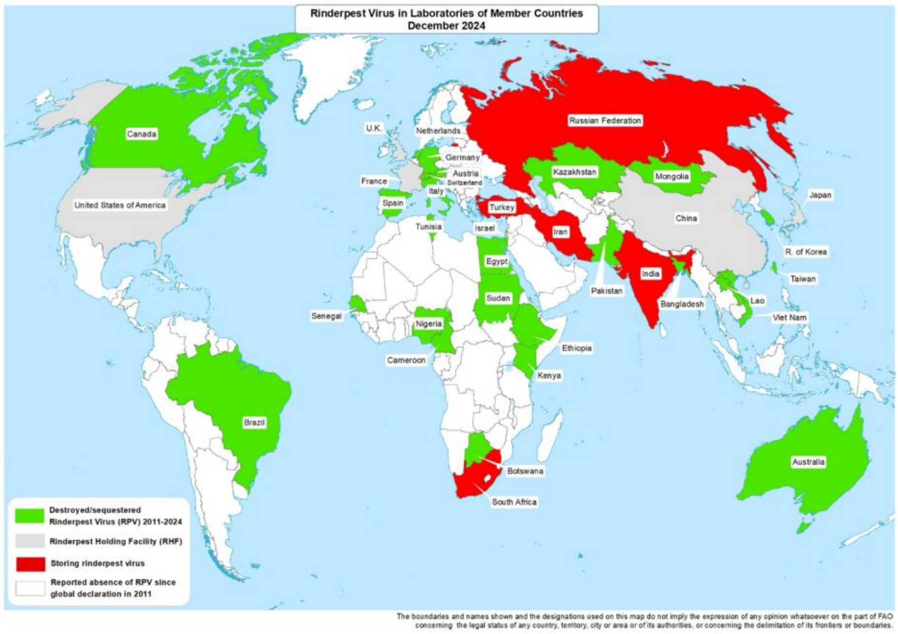


Figure 5. Rinderpest virus in laboratories of Member Countries in December 2024. Source: UN, 2021 modified with Rinderpest Virus in Laboratories of Member Countries.

Progress and challenges in the last year

FAO–WOAH joint activities:

- The number of countries storing RVCM outside RHFs was maintained at five.
- Sequence and Destroy projects have been initiated in two RHFs (In the UK and Japan) to decrease their RVCM inventory and to reduce the risk of re-emergence after approval from the JAC in April 2024. The Sequence and Destroy projects underway in China continued, while those in France and the USA were concluded.
- Two RHFs, in France and China, were inspected in October and December 2024, respectively. This was a condition of the 3-year mandate extension they were awarded in May 2023.
- The inspection of a candidate RHF in Bhopal, India, is scheduled for March 2025.The National Veterinary Institute (NVI), Ethiopia, started the extraordinary production of rinderpest vaccine to replenish the reserve at the Pan African Veterinary Vaccine Centre of the African Union (AU-PANVAC) in November 2024.
- CIRAD finalized the tests of on-campus cattle for exposure to RPV before their relocation - the results were negative.
- CIRAD finalized the QC of vaccine seed from the FAO reserve at CIRAD and from AU-PANVAC and shared the results with the RP Secretariat.
- The 4th meeting of the RHF network is scheduled to take place on 22-23 April 2025 at the FAO HQ.
- The 20th meeting of the JAC is scheduled to take place on 24-25 April 2025 at the FAO HQ.
- The annual reports of all RHFs were submitted using the Rinderpest Virus Tracking System (dedicated online platform).
- The annual survey on RVCM conducted by WOAH in November was launched. As of December 2024, four of the five countries holding RVCM outside RHFs had submitted their reports.

FAO-led activities:

- Support continued for the National Institute of Animal Health and National Agriculture and Food Research Organization (NIAH-NARO) in Japan to maintain the rinderpest vaccine reserve for regional and global deployment with a letter of agreement, valid until 2026.
- An FAO framework for activating the rinderpest vaccine reserve and deploying the vaccine is under review and discussion with the Ministry of Agriculture, Forestry and Fisheries (MAFF), Japan.
- Supported awareness and advocacy efforts to move forward with the discussions on destroy or sequestrate the rinderpest virus containing material (RVCM) except for vaccines and vaccine seed.
- The new seconded officer from the Ministry of Agriculture, Forestry and Fisheries of Japan (MAFF) joined FAO in November 2024 to support FAO Rinderpest Co-Secretariat.

WOAH-led activities:

- The Rinderpest Virus Tracking System was launched in 2017 and is hosted by WOAH with access granted to FAO. This system was used in 2024 to receive the annual reports of the FAO-WOAH designated RHFs.
- WOAH organised meetings with the Delegations of India and Türkiye during the 2024 General Session to discuss options for destruction or sequestration of the RVCM held in these countries. The meeting with Türkiye was fruitless, while the meeting with India allowed to advance the preparation of the site inspection of the candidate RHF.
- The Rinderpest chapter of the WOAH *Terrestrial* Manual is halfway through the revision process by the scientists of the WOAH Reference Laboratories for Rinderpest. This is part of a routine review of standards and the review cycle takes a minimum of 2 years between the first review and endorsement of the chapter by the General Assembly of Delegates.

Publications

1. Marrana, M., Arshed, M. J., Salman, M. Rinderpest – A disease of the past and a present threat. *Veterinary Clinics of North America: Food Animal Practice. 2024 Jul;40(2):337-343. doi: 10.1016/j.cvfa.2024.01.008. (Link here)*
2. *FAO. 2024. Rinderpest – A pocket guide for veterinary students and graduates. Rome. (link here)*

Funding for rinderpest post-eradication

FAO

- Ministry of Agriculture, Forestry and Fisheries (MAFF), Japan: March 2021–February 2026 (around US$ 285,000)

WOAH

DTRA: Rinderpest activities included in a broad GFTADs' grant funded by DTRA, which was signed in 2024

Avian influenza (AI) task force

Brief description of the task force and the process:

The AI task force has been established for an initial operating period for one year by the GF-TADs Management Committee (MC) on 20 April 2022. In its ~~first~~second year, the task force ~~is predominantly charged with reviewing and updating the FAO/WOAH AI global prevention and control strategy~~ continued meeting regularly every month with HPAI consultant expert group to ~~with reviewing~~ review and ~~updating finalise~~ develop the ~~FAO/WOAH~~ new ~~HPAI global strategy for the prevention and control strategy~~ Global strategy for the prevention and control of high pathogenicity avian influenza (2024–2033), which was last updated in 2008. ~~Another task will be the development of a proposal for a sustainable and longer-standing GF-TADs Working Group on AI, which would be charged with the follow-up of the implementation of the Strategy and related communications.~~

The AI Task Force is composed of two members from FAO, two members from WOAH and one member from the Global Secretariat for support. The current members are:

- FAO: Ismaila Seck (co-chair), Ihab Elmasry
- WOAH: Gounalan Pavade (co-chair), Alexandre Fediaevsky
- GFTAD Global Secretariat: Karima Ouali (support)

~~The AI-TF is guided by recommendations of the GF-TADs MC~~ The revised Global Strategy for the Prevention and Control of High Pathogenicity Avian Influenza was developed under the Global Framework for the Progressive Control of Transboundary Animal Diseases (GF-TADs) and coordinated by the GF-TADs High Pathogenicity Avian Influenza (HPAI) Task Force, under the guidance of the GF-TADs Management Committee. The AI-TF ~~will also~~ takes into account the standards of WOAH, relevant guidance and frameworks developed by the Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO), and work with Global Network of Expertise on Animal Influenza (OFFLU) on various technical matters ~~and~~while collaborating~~e~~ with other relevant bodies. It ~~will~~ collaborates with the other Quadripartite partners, WHO and UN Environment Programme (UNEP), on matters related to zoonotic influenzas and to wildlife, to share information and recommendations on risk management.

The Strategy was launched by the Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations (FAO) and the World Organisation for Animal Health (WOAH) ~~during~~jointly during the last session of the GF-TADS Global Steering Committee hosted as a side event of the WOAH 91st General Session in ~~MAy~~May 2024, ~~PAris~~Paris, France, and during a dedicated global FAO/WOAH webinar on 3 March 2025.

The strategy was promoted during various global and regional events such us~~,~~ the global event hosted by FAO on 17 March 2025 updating FAO Members on Avian Influenza Situation and the Pandemic Fund (3rd call)

Epidemiological situation

Global outbreaks of high pathogenicity avian influenza (HPAI) in poultry and wild birds have been occurring periodically over the past 20 years, impacting different regions of the world and leading to significant direct and indirect economic losses. Avian influenza is also a major concern for public health and has become an increasing threat to conservation and biodiversity. The transmission of avian influenza from birds to humans is usually sporadic, yet it has pandemic potential.

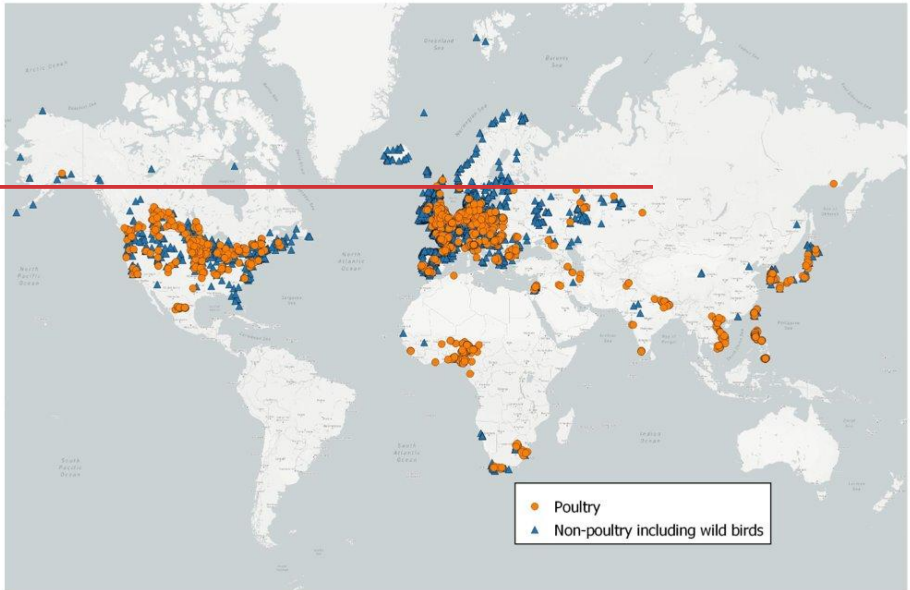
Since 2020, there has been a worldwide significant increase in the number of HPAI outbreaks affecting poultry and wild bird populations in all regions. The current HPAI epidemic, which began in late 2021, has been spreading through at least 73 countries and territories, and the predominant HPAI subtype involved is H5N1. In the last two years Europe and the Americas have faced the largest HPAI epidemic ever recorded.

Wild birds, including some endangered species, have also been severely affected by the disease. The consequences of avian influenza for wildlife could potentially have devastating effects on the biodiversity of our ecosystems. There is also observed persistence of H5 HPAI virus in wild birds throughout the year, indicating that the virus may have become endemic in certain wild bird populations. This implies a continuous risk of introduction to poultry, albeit with the highest risk in the autumn and winter months.

High pathogenicity avian influenza virus (HPAIV) continued to threaten animal and human health worldwide in 2024, albeit with detections in poultry and wild birds at lower levels than the previous two years. The majority of events in birds and wildlife were caused by the H5N1 clade 2.3.4.4b. In March 2024, H5N1 clade 2.3.4.4b was detected in dairy cows in the USA. Since March 2024, the detection of this virus in dairy cattle has caused an unprecedented spread throughout the USA in farmed animals and a major increase in animal-to-human spillover cases through exposure to infected premises. Other subtypes such as H5N5, H5N8, H5N3, and H5N6 have also been detected and caused outbreaks in poultry and/or wild birds. In some regions, multiple H5 clades, including 2.3.2.1a and 2.3.2.1e continue to circulate. The 2.3.2.1e clade has been linked to poultry outbreaks in multiple countries across the Mekong Delta region, including Cambodia, Vietnam, and Laos, with recent reports also involving captive big cats in Vietnam. Moreover, in 2024, Cambodia experienced a sudden increase in human spillover cases associated with a reassortant 2.3.2.1e lineage, which has acquired internal genes from clade 2.3.4.4b viruses. Similarly, clade 2.3.2.1a viruses circulating in India are also believed to have acquired internal genes from clade 2.3.4.4b viruses.

There were multiple emergence events of novel H7 subtype HPAIVs causing poultry outbreaks in Australasia, and human infections of low pathogenicity H3, H5, H9 and H10 subtypes of avian influenza viruses, reminding us of the continued threat avian influenza viruses pose to the poultry sector, wildlife and human health.

Following the incursion of HPAI outbreaks in South America and Antarctica, the disease has not only reached new and unusual territories but has also affected new uncommon species.



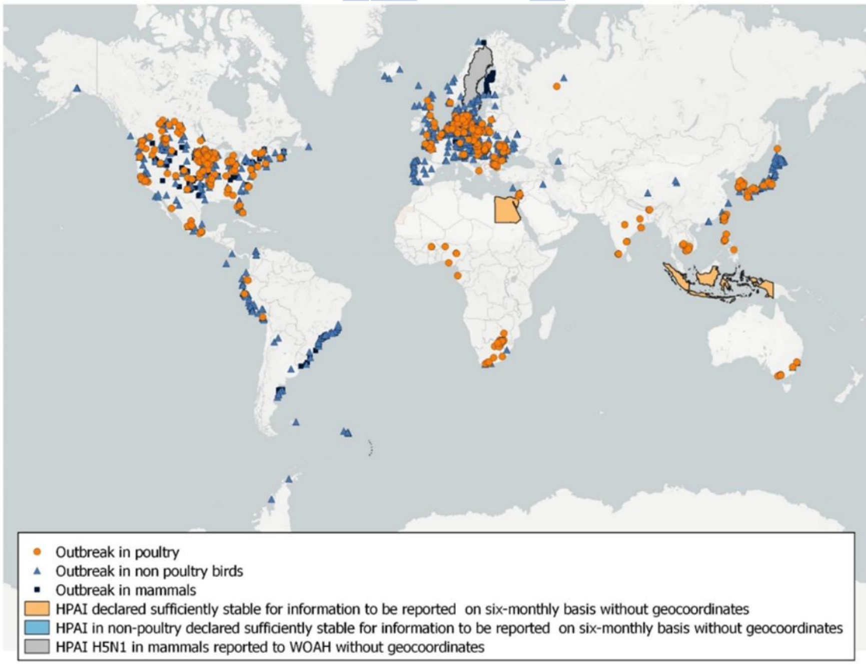


Figure 6. The HPAI situation, October 202~~1~~3 to September 202~~2~~4. Source: ~~GF-TADs HPAI taskforce.~~ WOAH-WAHIS situation report 63.

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Progress and challenges in the reporting period

Achievements

Task force ToR:

- Governance and terms of reference of the task force were drafted and finalised.
- A work plan calendar describing the activities of the task force for follow-up was finalised and is updated regularly.

Concept note for the revision of the AI prevention and control strategy:

- A concept note was drafted for the revision of the future AI global prevention and control strategy defining the scope and focus to consider, which included avian diseases/subtypes to be covered, animal species to be included and different stakeholders as the target audience.

Internal consultations on expectations of future AI global prevention and control strategy:

- Two internal consultations (22 and 29 September 2022) were conducted with regional and subregional FAO/WOAH offices and other FAO/WOAH affiliated experts who were involved in the implementation of the previous strategy to collect feedback on the expectations of the future strategy.
- The report of the internal consultations was presented to the MC meeting.

Online survey for assessment of 2008 HPAI strategy:

- A questionnaire online survey to collect feedback on the use and relevance of the 2008 HPAI strategy was drafted and finalised.
- The online survey will be sent to FAO/WOAH global, regional and subregional offices where AI projects were implemented between 2008 and 2018, as well as to Reference Centres.

Consultancy for the revision of global avian influenza prevention control strategy:

- The overall objective of the consultancy is to design a global AI prevention and control strategy to enable FAO, WOAH and their Members and partners to synchronise and harmonise AI control and eradication activities under different epidemiological situations.
- As a first step, the terms of reference for a consultant were drafted and presented to the MC for approval and a team of four consultants to align the strategy with higher-level policies.
- The development of the new HPAI strategy for 2024 – 2033 involved evidence gathered through regional and subregional virtual consultations, online surveys, reports from Regional GF-TADs Standing Group of Experts, and inputs received from the FAO global conference on HPAI and the WOAH Animal Health Forum on avian influenza (2023). Overarching strategies like GF-TAD Global strategy, the WOAH 7th strategic plan and FAO livestock transformation policy were consulted during the formulation.. Regular updates to the GF-TAD Management and Steering committee meetings led to approvals in the drafting process of the new strategy. The Strategy is set to undergo consultations and commenting process in early 2024. Following finalization of the Strategy, communication and launch options will be agreed and implemented by FAO and WOAH.

Commented [OK10]: @gounalan all this part was deleted by you in the other version. @all please have a look and let us know if its to be deleted or kept as acheivement.

Regional coordination and capacity building activities

- Americas: ~~Following recommendation from the standing group of experts (SGE) on HPAI created in December 2022, a technical meeting on HPAI vaccination and the second and third SGE meetings were organised in 2023 to engage stakeholders from the entire region, including from wildlife sector to exchange information on situation, control options, priorities and sharing of inter-regional experiences~~In the Americas, under the umbrella of GF-TADs, informative webinars were organised in April, May and November to share updates on the detection of

Commented [KA11]: Add webinars if any? ask Larissa.

HPAI in dairy cattle and humans in USA, with the presence of animal and human health authorities from USA.

- Update on avian influenza situation in humans and cattle, 29 November 2024, virtual
- GF-TADs Meeting: Detection of HPAI in Ruminants and Humans in the USA
- GF-TADs Meeting: Detection of HPAI in Ruminants and Humans in the USA (May 2024)
- ~~.~~GF-TADs Meeting: Detection of HPAI in Ruminants and Humans in the USA (April 2024)

- Europe: In 2023, ~~the Standing Group of Experts on High Pathogenicity Avian Influenza (SGE HPAI) was created including all 53 Members~~In Europe the second meeting of Standing Group of Experts on HPAI for Europe under GF-TADs was held in September at Samarkand, Uzbekistan.~~.~~ This joint initiative involving WOAH, FAO, and the European Commission (DG SANTE) aims to enhance cooperation in preventing and controlling HPAI. The SGE HPAI will regularly convene to review prevention and control strategies, exchange epidemiological information, share best practices, and formulate a coordinated strategy based on the One Health approach.

- ~~Asia-Pacific: The scientific network on avian influenza and other avian diseases organised a Regional Workshop for Avian Disease Prevention and Control in August 2023 in China (Rep Popular) and continued to support Members to strengthen the regional effort to control avian infectious diseases by promoting information sharing on all bacterial and viral avian diseases in addition to those described in WOAH *Terrestrial Code*.~~Asia-Pacific:~~ The scientific network on avian influenza and other avian diseases organised a Regional Workshop for Avian Disease Prevention and Control in August 2023 in China (Rep Popular) and continued to support Members to strengthen the regional effort to control avian infectious diseases by promoting information sharing on all bacterial and viral avian diseases in addition to those described in WOAH *Terrestrial Code*. In the Asia-Pacific region the scientific network on avian influenza and other avian diseases organised a~~ Regional Workshop for Avian Disease Prevention and Control in Seoul, Republic of Korea in August and continued to support Members to strengthen the regional effort to control avian viral and bacterial infectious diseases particularly on avian Influenza. The regional workshop was held in collaboration with the One Health Poultry Hub~~One Health Poultry Hub and recommended continuing disease surveillance and monitoring activities in domestic and wild birds, improving information sharing, diagnostic capacity and early warning systems and strengthening collaborations to initiate the regional plan of actions based on global avian influenza strategy and resolution.~~

- Africa

Commented [KA12]: re regional capacity building activities: @Ismaila, Biosecurity on poultry farming in one or two countries? also Farmers Field School in Kenya Tanzania Zimbabwe? (for this pls ask Kivaria perhaps)

OFFLU (WOAH-FAO network of expertise on animal influenza) and WOAH Scientific network activities

The WOAH/FAO Network of expertise on animal influenza (OFFLU), with the OFFLU Secretariat and the OFFLU website, hosted by WOAH and OFFLU Scientist hosted by FAO,~~,~~ played a significant role in the context of the evolving epidemiological situation.

~~In response to the global surge of avian influenza outbreaks, the OFFLU network was active in exchanging data, publishing scientific statements to address emerging animal influenza threats and conducting risk assessments. The network regularly contributes with WHO influenza vaccine~~

~~composition meetings. The OFFLU avian influenza matching (AIM) pilot project was completed to provide information on antigenic characteristics of circulating viruses to facilitate selection of appropriate vaccines for poultry and update of poultry vaccine antigens in places where vaccines are being used.~~

~~The network released scientific statements to address emerging animal influenza threats which include statement on high pathogenicity avian influenza caused by viruses of the H5N1 subtype, avian influenza events in wildlife, mammals and cats .~~

~~The following are examples of technical documents developed to support national surveillance and control efforts:~~

- ~~Avian influenza events in mammals~~
- ~~Statement on HPAI caused by H5N1 subtype~~
- ~~Statement on infections with avian influenza H5N1 in cats in Poland~~
- ~~Avian influenza in the Latin America and Caribbean region~~
- ~~Southward expansion of HPAI H5 in wildlife in South America~~
- ~~Continued expansion of HPAI H5 in wildlife in South America and incursion into the Antarctic region~~

~~The OFFLU network regularly contributes with WHO influenza Vaccine Composition Meetings (VCM). The network participated in the February and September~~ 2023 WHO VCM 2023 WHO VCM and provided a total of 2 619 H5, H7, and H9 avian influenza virus sequences isolated in Europe, Asia-Pacific, the Middle East, Africa, and the Americas. In addition, 588 H1 and H3 swine influenza virus sequences were shared. Antigenic data were generated by the haemagglutination inhibition assay using WHO Collaborating Centre and OFFLU ferret-origin reagents. The reports are available online.~~and provided a total of 2 619 H5, H7, and H9 avian influenza virus sequences isolated in Europe, Asia-Pacific, the Middle East, Africa, and the Americas. In addition, 588 H1 and H3 swine influenza virus sequences were shared. Antigenic data were generated by the haemagglutination inhibition assay using WHO Collaborating Centre and OFFLU ferret-origin reagents. The reports are available online.~~

OFFLU network regularly met virtually to discuss and share data on circulating animal influenza threats. The experts analysed the virological update of the virus circulating in dairy cows and compiled the diagnostic guidance for sample collection and testing in cattle. Scientific documents were published which included a statement on high pathogenicity avian influenza in dairy cows, diagnostic guidance for HPAI in dairy cattle and avian influenza epidemiological and genetic updates. Additionally OFFLU swine and equine influenza experts also met to share recent surveillance and research findings.

OFFLU held its global technical meeting at FAO headquarters in July 2024, where the operational methods and terms of reference of various technical activities (avian, swine, equine, wildlife, epidemiology, human-animal interface, socio-economic) of the network were discussed and updated. The network organised a webinar in July 2024 (English, Spanish) on the Avian Influenza Matching (AIM) for Poultry Vaccines to share the second technical report and followed by an executive summary report (October 2024) of the project. These reports assist decision-makers WOAH Members in developing evidence-based guidelines and policies for effective vaccination strategies.

The network contributed animal influenza data to the February and September 2024 WHO Vaccine Composition Meeting. The OFFLU network regularly contributes to WHO influenza Vaccine Composition Meetings (VCM). The network participated in the February and September 2024 WHO VCM and provided H5, H7 and H9 avian influenza virus sequences isolated in Europe, Asia-Pacific, the Middle East, Africa and the Americas. In addition, H1 and H3 swine influenza virus sequences were shared. Antigenic data were generated by the haemagglutination inhibition assay using WHO Collaborating Centre and OFFLU ferret-origin reagents. The full reports are available online.

The OFFLU proficiency testing panel for the year 202~~3~~4 was received by WOAH/FAO Reference Centres and was designed to assess the capability of the laboratories to detect and characterise isolates of avian influenza. The round was coordinated by the Australian Centre for Disease Preparedness (ACDP) and conducted under their ISO 17043 accreditation.

The reports of the OFFLU Steering and Executive Committee meetings ~~is~~ are available online.

FAO and WOAH conducted activities on their own contributing to the prevention and control.

Highligh on FAO activities contributing to HPAI prevention and control

- Through its extensive network of decentralized offices and field teams, FAO is actively monitoring the risk of HPAI spread by gathering and analysing information, and supported Members by providing the latest information and guidance on protection for agricultural workers, field teams, and other outbreak responders.
- FAO promoted coordinated HPAI prevention and control as well as biosecurity on farms and throughout value chains. This includes the delivery of trainings through FAO Virtual Learning Centers and community of practice (CoP).
- FAO supported its Members by providing capacity development to strengthen surveillance, diagnostic capabilities, preparedness, introducing applied technologies, risk assessments, and technical guidance on coordinated One Health actions on risk mitigation along poultry value chains. This included in-person and virtual AI-related trainings.
- FAO continues to play a pivotal role in global HPAI risk monitoring and early warning, issuing monthly situation updates on avian influenza viruses with zoonotic potential, including regional analyses for HPAI in Sub-Saharan Africa. In response to emerging risks in North America, FAO published Recommendations on A(H5N1) surveillance in cattle and released an *EMPRES Watch* on influenza A(H5N1) in dairy cattle in the United States of America. In addition, an alert on H5 HPAI in the Americas was published in December 2024 to further underscore the need for enhanced surveillance and preparedness. These efforts reflect FAO's ongoing commitment in providing timely, science-based guidance to support prevention, preparedness, and coordinated global response.

The Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO) has implemented several key activities during this reporting period to prevent and control Highly Pathogenic Avian Influenza (HPAI), focusing on surveillance, capacity building, regional coordination, and strategic planning.

Commented [OK13]: I have re included my inputs here maybe helpful if teh team can have a look and update

For an improved surveillance and early Detection of HPAI:

- **Guidelines for influenza surveillance in cattle and other mammals**: In December 2024, FAO released new guidelines to help countries implement effective surveillance programs for early detection of influenza in cattle. This initiative responds to the spread of HPAI H5N1 virus, particularly the clade 2.3.4.4b strain, which has infected various species, including cattle. The guidelines designed to improve early detection of spillover events, support evidence-based disease control measures, and help countries optimize the use of limited resources through integrated surveillance strategies while emphasizing on the importance of passive surveillance systems that encourage reporting of suspected cases from farmers and veterinarians.

- **Regional situation updates**: FAO has been providing regular updates on the global situation of avian influenza viruses with zoonotic potential, including H5N1, H5N5, and H5N9 strains, featuring data and maps from the FAO EMPRES Global Animal Disease Information System (EMPRES-i). These updates are facilitating a timely access to animal disease information and intelligence while assisting countries in monitoring and responding to outbreaks effectively.
- FAO Virtual Learning Centres are collaborating with the Friedrich-Loeffler-Institut (FLI) to update the existing avian influenza course with elements of the increasing incidents of HPAIV infections in mammals

For capacity building and training: To effectively prevent and control Highly Pathogenic Avian Influenza (HPAI), FAO prioritizes strengthening the skills and knowledge of animal health professionals and stakeholders. Through targeted training programs, workshops, and awareness campaigns, FAO enhances the ability of local and regional actors to detect, investigate, and respond to outbreaks promptly and efficiently. These efforts contribute to building resilient veterinary services and empowering communities to manage HPAI risks sustainably. Some of these initiatives were:

- **Training on outbreak investigation**: In July 2024, FAO and Cambodia's General Directorate of Animal Health and Production organized training for provincial veterinarians on Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) for HPAI outbreak investigation. The training aimed to enhance the capacity of local veterinarians in implementing effective outbreak investigations and responses.
- **Sub-saharan Africa initiatives**: FAO supported various capacity-building activities in Sub-Saharan Africa, including:
  - On-site training on avian influenza diagnosis for technical personnel in The Gambia.
  - A nationwide public sensitization and awareness campaign in The Gambia to inform rural communities about HPAI and the importance of reporting suspected incidents.
  - Training of animal health staff and transport unions in Guinea on the mechanism for the secure transport of animal biological samples in order to enhance the skills of those involved in animal and zoonotic disease surveillance.
  - Training workshops in Guinea-Bissau covering disease recognition, biosecurity, sample collection, and surveillance.
  - National stakeholder workshop in Nigeria on HPAI control and prevention.
  - Support for small-scale poultry farmers in Kenya through Farmer Field Schools (FFS) to improve practices in antimicrobial resistance management, biosecurity, and broiler production.
  - Mentorship and training of 10 laboratory staff in Liberia on PCR testing and sample collection.

Regional coordination and response

- **Latin america and the caribbean**: FAO issued an alert in 2024 highlighting the risk of HPAI upsurge and regional spread through wild birds in the region. The alert called for increased vigilance and preparedness, recommending enhanced measures for early detection, diagnosis, outbreak response, and coordination with neighboring countries under a One Health approach. Open Knowledge FAO
- **Americas**: FAO, in collaboration with regional organizations, held a virtual workshop in February 2025 to update and strengthen the diagnosis, control, and prevention of HPAI in the Americas. The workshop provided recommendations for countries in the region to prevent and control the disease.

Highligh on WOAH activities contributing to HPAI prevention and control

~~In light of the ongoing global avian influenza crisis, WOAH hosted its first Animal Health Forum (AHF), fully dedicated to the disease during WOAH's 90th General Session. The Animal Health Forum 'Policy to Action: The case of avian influenza – Reflections for change' provided an opportunity for open discussions among Delegates, subject-matter experts and relevant stakeholders on how best to address current challenges in the global control of high pathogenicity avian influenza. The Technical Item titled 'Strategic Challenges in the Global Control of High Pathogenicity Avian Influenza' presented at the event set the stage for the AHF, and WOAH Members adopted the Resolution N.28 served as a basis for shaping future avian influenza control activities. The Resolution underscores the importance of Members respecting and implementing WOAH international standards to effectively combat avian influenza.~~

~~A two-year Resolution N.28 framework (June 2023 – May 2025) was designed in consultation with key WOAH stakeholders to define the activities, outputs and expected outcomes to implement the recommendations of the adopted resolution and ensure alignment with the future GF-TAD AI Global strategy.~~

~~The WOAH avian influenza scientific network continued to deliver concrete outputs that contribute to the mitigation of risks posed by zoonotic animal influenza viruses to public and animal health. The WOAH scientific network, FAO, and WHO are in regular communication to share public health and animal health data so that risk assessments are continually updated on issues related to the animal–human interface, including the publication of a rapid risk assessment of H5N1 clade 2.3.4.4b viruses and human infection with H5N1 in Cambodia.~~. High pathogenic avian influenza continues to be a global threat impacting national economies, public health, food security and biosecurity. WOAH Members adopted Resolution No. 28 at 90th General Session in May 2023 to guide future avian influenza control efforts while protecting wildlife, supporting the poultry industry and ensuring trade continuity. WOAH pursued a two-year resolution implementation framework (June 2023 – May 2025) to guide activities during 2024. All the 19 recommendations of the resolution have at least one related activity underway and of the 29 indicators, 16 have already been achieved within the first year of implementation.

As requested by our Members, WOAH is developing guidelines for avian influenza surveillance in small poultry holders in resource limited settings. The WOAH Working Group on Wildlife, and experts from the National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration published a practical guide for authorised field responders to HPAI in marine mammals with a focus on biosecurity, sample collection for virus detection and carcass disposal. WOAH in collaboration with the International Alliance for Biological Standardization (IABS) co-organised a meeting on vaccination and surveillance for HPAI at Paris in October 2024 to assess the latest scientific data for HPAI surveillance programs in vaccinated poultry. The meeting conclusions and recommendations were published.

The Biological Standards Commission, with the support of WOAH Reference Laboratories' avian influenza experts continue reviewing and updating Terrestrial Manual Chapter 3.3.4. on avian influenza with the goal of being adopted in May 2025 General Session.

The WOAH avian influenza scientific network continued to deliver concrete outputs that contribute to the mitigation of risks posed by zoonotic animal influenza viruses to public and animal health.

Highlight on the Quadripartite organizations' activities on HPAI

Commented [KA14]: there were more assessments, not only on Cambodia

Commented [KA15R14]: An AI specific QPT consultation on was held as well

FAO, WHO and WOAH are in regular communication to share public health and animal health data so that risk assessments are continually updated on issues related to the human-animal-environment interface, including the publication of three joint assessments addressing influenza A(H5) virus events in animals and people (April, August, and December 2024).

Regular information on emerging AI viruses is also shared through the FAO–WOAH-WHO Global Early Warning System for health threats and emerging risks at the human–animal–ecosystems interface (GLEWS+) platform for rapid risk assessment.

On 17 December 2024, FAO, WHO and WOAH were invited to the UN Geneva press briefing to present the updated situation of H5N1 avian influenza worldwide.

In October-December 2024, the Quadripartite avian influenza group organized a virtual consultation series to identify gaps and strengthen coordination in surveillance, information sharing, risk assessment, and communications.

- *HPAI notifications and situation reports*

WOAH continues to monitor the notification of the occurrence of avian influenza through WAHIS and generates ~~reports~~ situation reports that provide an update of the avian influenza situation at both global and regional levels. The ~~do~~reports~~cuments~~ briefly present the key risks driving current events – how the strains are interacting with hosts (both wild birds and poultry, and sometimes humans) and the environment (seasonality, livestock husbandry systems, ecosystems) and how the events may evolve in the months ahead. ~~The production frequency of these situation reports is largely driven by the number and severity of notifications for avian influenza received in WAHIS.~~ In parallel with these written situation reports, WOAH has developed monthly situation report videos for social media, that explain the progress of HPAI as reported by Members.

Commented [KA16]: Do we need to mention empres-i and Global AIV and Subsaharan HPAI update? or these are not GF-TADs so should not be mentioned? (but WAHIS and Gounalan's situation reports are also only WOAH...)

- *Advocacy and communication*

WOAH has developed several videos with experts to raise awareness on avian influenza and address key questions. These videos are available here and were disseminated across social media channels throughout the year.

A video statement given by the Director General of WOAH, in response to the increasing number of dairy cattle infected by the virus in the United States of America was released to advocate for increased surveillance of avian influenza's spread in mammals and was disseminated across social media channels and on the WOAH global website.

~~Articles were also written on the topic and shared online:~~ Statements to inform and advice Member ~~were published~~were published and regularly updated as scientific information becomes available:

- ~~Avian influenza vaccination: why it should not be a barrier to safe trade~~
- ~~Avian influenza: understanding new dynamics to better combat the disease~~
- ~~Avian influenza: why strong public policies are vital - WOAH - World Organisation for Animal Health https://www.woah.org/en/egg-prices-on-the-rise-the-effects-of-animal-diseases/~~

~~Tackling avian influenza: the role of Veterinary Services~~Avian influenza vaccination and why it should not be a barrier to safe trade

– High pathogenicity avian influenza (HPAI) in cattle (December 2024)

– Wildlife under threat as avian influenza reaches antarctica

In the Asia-Pacific region the scientific network on avian influenza and other avian diseases organised a Regional Workshop for Avian Disease Prevention and Control in Seoul, Republic of Korea in August and continued to support Members to strengthen the regional effort to control avian viral and bacterial infectious diseases particularly on avian Influenza. The regional workshop was held in collaboration with the One Health Poultry Hub and recommended continuing disease surveillance and monitoring activities in domestic and wild birds, improving information sharing, diagnostic capacity and early warning systems and strengthening collaborations to initiate the regional plan of actions based on global avian influenza strategy and resolution.

In Middle East, a meeting was organised on 17-19 December in Amman, Jordan. The objectives of the meeting were to review the current HPAI situation globally and regionally in light of the Global HPAI Strategy (2024-2033), to discuss advancements in avian influenza control and eradication strategies, including the role of vaccination, to strengthen national and regional surveillance and reporting systems for HPAI and to foster collaboration and knowledge-sharing among Middle Eastern countries to develop effective prevention and control measures. More information: Regional Coordination Meeting on HPAI Situation in the Middle East and Action Plans Guided by Global HPAI Strategy - WOAH - Middle East

Funding for HPAI

xxx

xxxxx

FAO

- xxx

WOAH

- ~~xxxxxx~~OFFLU avian influenza matching project (AIM 2 and AIM 3 project)
- OFFLU swine influenza technical meeting, April 2024, WOAH HQ, Paris
- Expert consultants for developing the new global HPAI strategy

Regional priority TADs

Regional priorities of the GF-TADs for Africa

Websites : Link 1 and Link 2

WOAH continues to have a significant impact in the control of rabies in Africa, notably in Namibia, where both animal and human rabies have been reduced significantly following intensive mass vaccination of pets.

Funds were allocated funds (Italy V) for the project "**Tools to implement a harmonised canine rabies control program in the Northern African region**", developed by IZS Padova, which has been newly appointed as WOAH Reference Laboratory. The project will target 3 Members (Algeria, Morocco and Tunisia) and will include 3 working packages: Establish National Strategic Plans, Enhance Surveillance and Facilitate communication and Awareness. The project was finalised and its official validation/signature is expected to be concluded by March 2025 and the start of activities is foreseen in April 2025.

The project has supported the implementation of national strategic plan activities for rabies in other Central and West Africa countries and globally through several stakeholder meetings organised with Central African Republic, Chad and Congo Rep. National rabies strategic plans were developed in Chad and Central African Republic, and vaccine donations from the WOAH vaccine bank were completed for Cameroon (250,000 doses), Guinea (100,000 doses) and Burkina Faso (50,000 doses) to support the Members in their rabies control programmes.

TADs activities were successfully carried out where regional priorities on the control of ASF, CBPP, FMD and PPR were outlined through various regional coordination and standing group of experts meetings. It is critical to escalate the outcomes of these SGE meetings and roadmap meetings to the RSC and Global Steering Committee (GSC) to draw attention to the importance of such gatherings and prioritise the activities to meet the Members' needs.

African Swine Fever and Contagious Bovine PleuroPneumonia

FAO-WOAH joint Activities

The **SGEs for ASF and CBPP** continued to strengthen their roles and held their 4th and 2nd meetings in 2024 (as online and in-person meetings respectively). The **2nd SGE on CBPP** met and agreed on the development and validation of strategic plans at various levels of governance, including the continental level, and for such cases as affected, threatened and disease-free Members, control using epi-systems approaches, and international supporting frameworks. The **4th SGE on ASF** discussed strategies to improve outbreak response to ASF in Africa. The SGE identified vaccine and vaccination as a priority for the next SGE meeting in 2025. The **coordination meetings on FMD** highlighted the need to foster an enabling environment for FMD control and emergency management particularly to increase advocacy for increased investments, effective and sustainable vaccination, implementing movement control during outbreaks to minimise diseases spread, enhance capacity for and surveillance to provide timely information needed to control FMD across boundaries.

The development of the Eastern Africa FMD virus Reference Antigen Panel through a collaboration between the World Reference Laboratory for FMD (WRLFMD) at the Pirbright Institute and the WOAH/FAO FMD Reference Laboratory Network, including AU-PANVAC, will improve understanding of expected vaccine efficacy within Eastern African and subsequently improve response to vaccination.

Two Inter-Regional Economic Community meetings in April 2024 and December 2024 discussed the improvement of continental and regional coordination for the harmonisation of PPR disease management and preparation for the implementation of PPR eradication following the signing of the EU-supported PPR eradication in Africa project in November 2024. The preparation of the second phase of the EU-supported PPR eradication project was initiated with consultants providing a roadmap for developing project documents. The meeting was organised by AU-IBAR with the support of the PPR Global Secretariat.

The PPR Episystem guidelines developed by the PPR secretariat were launched during the Lake Chad Episystem meeting in Yaounde, Cameroon, in April 2024. The guidelines will support countries to include an episystem approach in their PPR national strategic plans as emphasised in the ECOWAS PPR roadmap meeting in June 2024.

The involvement of the private sector in PPR eradication has become apparent with Tanzania seeking WOAH support in developing Public Private Partnership models in PPR eradication. In this regard, WOAH supported Tanzania through a PVS mission on PPP in July and November 2024.

The **Prevention and Control of Transboundary Diseases (PC-TAD)** project achieved significant milestones in 2024, advancing efforts to control Peste des Petits Ruminants (PPR) in Kenya and Ethiopia. Key accomplishments included the launch of a nationwide PPR vaccination campaign in Kenya, conducted in collaboration with the Kenyan government. These activities were underpinned by comprehensive seromonitoring, funded and supported through project resources, to assess disease prevalence and vaccination needs in both Kenya and Ethiopia. The project had a strong stakeholder engagements, awareness campaigns and bolstered intersectoral collaboration, significantly advancing the control of PPR and other transboundary animal diseases.

Under **PRAPS-2**, National Strategic Plans for PPR eradication in Mali, Mauritania, Senegal, and Chad are being revised and re-budgeted, based on recent vaccination results and case data. These countries are also being introduced to the episystem approach and its implementation. Additionally, technical support has been provided to Guinea and other countries in the sub-region for developing their National PPR Eradication Plan.

Contagious Bovine PleuroPneumonia

FAO-WOAH joint activities

Over two weeks (6 – 15 June 2023) and six online sessions, the GF-TADs for Africa Secretariat organized the inaugural meeting of the *standing group of experts* (SGE) for CBPP, following the adoption in 2022 of the terms of reference for the Africa-region by the 11th Regional Steering Committee (RSC-11) of the GF-TADs for Africa. The disease was identified as one of the 5 priority diseases under the GF-TADs Regional Strategy 2021 – 2025, adopted in October 2021. The SGE-CBPP for Africa was established with a core group of 4 founding Members Countries drawn from Central (Chad), Eastern (Somalia), Southern (Zambia) and Western Africa (Nigeria), with the aim to progressively extend to more countries. The online meeting was attended by 45 individuals over the 6 sessions. The meeting was attended by the four CVOs and WOAH Delegates, together with other participants. The agenda was designed, over several weeks of preparatory meetings with partner organizations and identified experts, to cover four pillars:

- Governance aspects, to do with the establishment and operation of the SGE itself.
- General introductions to the disease, reporting, international standards and country situations
- Presentations and discussions with a focus on technology
- Presentations and discussions with a focus on policy

The final discussion culminated in the identification of a number of priority topics, to be tackled in subsequent meetings, as intended in the terms of reference of the SGE. These are:

- Strategy
- Surveillance

- Diagnosis
- Vaccines
- Policy
- Research

The focus of the next meeting will therefore be 'strategy', including the development and validation of strategic plans at various levels of governance (national, clusters of neighboring countries, sub-regions, the continent and/or the international community), for higher prioritization of the disease, both technically and financially. The meeting will likely be held as a face-to-face meeting in Lusaka, Zambia, jointly hosted by the Government of Zambia and the COMESA Secretariat. The report of the inaugural meeting is available here.

Regional priorities of the GF-TADs for the Americas

Websites: Link 1 and Link 2
No specific activities on regional priority TADs rabies and new world screwworm during that period.

Regional GF-TADs acted as a platform for coordination on Screwworm affected countries and after the HPAI detection in North America.

Regional priorities of the GF-TADs for Asia and the Pacific

Websites: Link 1 and Link 2

- The **27th SEACFMD Sub-Commission Meeting** was important to replace FMD high in the agenda, to undergo foresight exercises on the future of FMD situation in the region and to guide the development of the upcoming SEACFMD Roadmap 2026 – 2030.
- With the support of WOAH, the **ASEAN LSD Prevention and Control Strategy** was finalised and endorsed by the ASEAN Governing Bodies including ASWGL, SOM-AMAF and AMAF. The new strategy will provide clear guidance to the ASEAN countries to fight LSD in the coming years
- The implementation plan and M&E baselines for the ASEAN ASF Prevention and Control Strategy was finalised during the **4th ASF Coordination for South-East Asia** organised jointly between WOAH and the ASEAN in Vietnam in November 2024.

Lumpy Skin disease

FAO-WOAH joint activities

LSD was included First South Asia transboundary animal diseases coordination meeting for peste des petits ruminants, foot-and-mouth disease and lumpy skin disease organised on 8-12 May 2023 in Bhutan, allowing for good exchanges between Members and internal experts on the complex epidemiological situation and the formulation of tailored recommendations for the subregion.

The 4th LSD Coordination Meeting for South-East Asia was held back-to-back with the meeting of the Core Group and Advisory Group for the development of ALPCS on 2830 November 2023. The 4th LSD Coordination Meeting reviewed the LSD situation, assessed progress of LSD prevention and control in South-East Asia and to discuss the key challenges faced by the Members in LSD prevention and control. A series of brainstorming sessions were held to define problems, goal, objectives, outcomes and outputs of the draft strategy. Following the LSD coordination meeting, the Meeting of the Core Group and Advisory Group discussed and finalised the draft theory of change (TOC) and an outline for the ALPCS.

FAO leaded activities

FAO RAP continued with a programmatic approach using multiple resources particularly on ASF as listed below:

- Continue regular coordination among HQ/region/countries as well as with other implementing partners to synergize efforts for ASF.
- RAP supported WOAH SRR to develop ASEAN ASF strategy. Plus, using other complementary projects, RAP supported for some countries contingency plan/SOPs.

- At the regional level, overall, 1500 animal health officials were trained for ASF detection and response. Some of the trainings were supported by the DTRA project. In Aug 2023, RAP conducted SimEx for ASF outbreak response where RAP trained 28 people from 11 countries. This SimEx was cost-shared with other complementary projects. After the regional exercise, countries are utilizing further the materials: Malaysia with their own fund used SimEx model for rabies and Solomon Island under TCP ran SimEx using same material for their ASF preparedness. Further in-country level of SimEx supported by DTRA funds for Cambodia, Lao PDR and Thailand.
- FAO RAP worked with TAFS forum to build private sector engagement mechanism.
- Some works have been conducted on capacity building: online course on value chain analysis.
- Together with DLD (department of livestock development, Thailand), pig production system was analysed on value chain mapping, economic analysis and risk analysis along the value chain which became a good baseline for setting up the national plan on ASF control.
- Pilot project was conducted by Mahidol university (FAO reference centre for wildlife) on risk of wild boar and ASF risk in Thailand and GMS (Greater Mekong subregion).

WOAH leaded activities

A LSD coordination meeting was organised for East Asia as a side event of CVO forum in July 2023

Regional priorities of the GF-TADs for Europe

Websites: Link 1 and Link 2

GF-TADs activities (FMD, PPR, LSD):

This year was notably different from previous years, as PPR outbreaks were detected in some Europe countries that were officially recognised by WOAH as PPR-free. Given this emerging situation, the PPR Secretariat for the West Eurasia Roadmap, with the support from the EU DG-SANTE, responded quickly to the needs of Members.

The successful PPR webinar in early September allowed WOAH to disseminate the information among the countries of the Europe Region. Moreover, our forecast to include PPR as a priority disease of the Europe Region under the GF-TADs has been positively assessed by our main donor and partner as EU DG-SANTE.

Lumpy Skin disease

FAO-WOAH joint activities

FAO, WOAH and the EU DG SANTE organised the SGE on LSD-12 held in March 2023 recognising the good experience of South-East Europe Members to tackle LSD decided to develop similar approach in Caucasus and Central Asia countries in the future.

FAO leaded activities

In 2023, FAO REU organised trainings for three countries (Uzbekistan, Tajikistan, Kyrgyzstan) including simulation exercises, surveillance and vaccination, laboratory diagnostic and provided some reagent.

A 4-week tutored course (15 hours of study time) was developed by HSA and FAO REU VLC in 2022 with primary audience for veterinarians (public & private), this was delivered in Russian language from May – June 2023 with 150 participants from 14 countries

The FAO Field manual for veterinarians on LSD for private and official vets, para-professionals and lab diagnosticians is available in English, Chinese , Macedonian , Romanian , Serbian, Ukrainian , Albanian, Turkish and Russian

The FAO Guidelines for livestock vaccination campaigns for veterinary services is available in: English, Russian and Azerbaijani

WOAH leaded activities

In a collaborative endeavour aimed at fostering knowledge exchange among regional stakeholders, the World Organisation for Animal Health (WOAH) and Sciensano, the EU Reference Laboratory on LSD, jointly organized an impactful online seminar focused on laboratory diagnostics and vaccines for Lumpy Skin Disease (LSD) on December 13, 2023. This event served as a crucial follow-up to the recommendations from the last SGE on LSD-12 held in March 2023: Exploring Lumpy Skin Disease - WOAH – Europe

Rabies (surveillance oral vaccination of wildlife)

FAO-WOAH joint activities

FAO, WOAH and the EU DG SANTE organised the SGE RAB5 - 5th meeting of the Standing Groups of Experts on Rabies for Europe which took place on July 4th, 2023, with over 40 participants present from 14 countries and three international organizations.

The main objective of this new Standing Group of Experts is to coordinate the oral rabies vaccination activities in wild carnivores with the overall goal to accelerate the final eradication of rabies, primarily in the Balkan sub-region.

Regional priorities of the GF-TADs for the Middle East

Websites: Link 1 and Link 2

No specific activities were conducted on RVF and Brucellosis during that period.

Annex. Follow-up on the recommendations of the GSC14

Source: FAO and WOAH, 2024 14th Meeting of the Global Steering Committee of the Global Framework for the Progressive Control of Transboundary Animal Diseases (GF-TADS). Recommendations of the virtual meetings, 30 April, 7 and 27 May 2024. https://shorturl.at/QTcGq

	Recommendation	Status & progress	Comment
Recommendation 1	Management Committee (MC) to extend the period of implementation of the GF-TADs Global Strategy 2021-2025 to the end of 2026 to allow for priority gaps to be identified and addressed, annual progress reports and final assessment made, and high-level management of FAO and WOAH re-algin the next GF-TADs strategy with FAO and WOAH visions.		GS to produce progress report for 2023, 2024, 2025: every yearGS to produce final report in 2026 for 2021-2026: 2026 GS to propose CN on final assessment and expression of the vision(s) for next strategy: 2025
Recommendation 2	MC and Regional Steering Committees (RSC) to provide guidance to review representation, roles, and engagement of the different groups/bodies in GF-TADs, including the partnership and financing panel, and suggest necessary revisions to their terms of references (TORs), by the next GSC meeting aiming at enhanced coordination, simplification and increased efficiency of governing bodies with a focus on holistic and systems-based approaches rather than disease by disease;		ToRs to review: GSC (2019), 5 RSC (2020-2022), ASF WG (2020), FMD WG (2015?), PPR Secretariat (2015 expired ion 2018, revision in 2021-2023 not adopted), HPAI TF (2022)/WG, Rinderpest Secretariat (2023?), MC (2019), GS (2019), 5 RS (2020-2022), PFP (2022), 7 FMD RAG (2023?), 7 PPR RAG (2023?), ASF GCC (2023), FMD GCC (2022), PPR AC (2023), PPR GREN (?), Rinderpest JAC (2024), 4 SGE ASF (2015-2022), 2 SGE HPAI (2022), 2 SGE LSD (2015,2023), 1 SGE CBPP (2023), 1 SGE Rabies wildlife (2020?), 1 PPR Pan African Secretariat (2023) use A.I. to compare / summarize? GS to develop position note - end November
Recommendation 3	Regional steering committees, disease working groups and standing group of experts to regularly identify and report specific national needs and to formulate actionable cross-cutting or disease-specific SMART recommendations		GS to inform/remind colleagues in each organisation involved in recommendation drafting GS explore if general principles on drafting SMART recommendation can be formulated /

			is needed GS to receive / review draft recommendation and suggest if needed reformulation of Recs circulated to improve 'SMART"ness / have a systematic digitilatisation of Recommendations
Recommendation 4	Global secretariat (GS), disease working groups and regional secretariats (RS), under the supervision of MC, to inform stakeholders on the implementation of recommendations, using key performance indicators, evolution of TADs situation and associated risks and to inform on planned activities and outcomes.		generate the publically accessible space of the GF-TADS Sharepoint organise information (by Nov) on list and follow up of adopted recommendations at G and R levelsdashboard on existing KPIslinks to TADs information/reports/assessments produced by EMPRES-i, GLEWS, WAHISlink to Licslink to dashboard on activities propose to MC for validation and diffusion list additional information to provide (on outcomes, source of fundings…)
Recommendation 5	MC, with the support of the GS and guidance from the PFP, to produce an advocacy document to foster necessary political engagement to tackle TADs, emphasizing global public health and socioeconomic benefits of TADs control, within one year;		GS to explore with PFP how the work from Apolline Bougrat could be used to be used to develop such policy documents and other documents such as recent gbads publication (link) - explore possibility for publication for instance in WOAH revue.
Recommendation 6	MC and RSCs to enhance global and regional GF-TADs coordination through targeted, region-specific and disease groups/secretariats evaluation and feedback and considering alternative ways to participate in governing bodies , considering available resources, by the end of the current Global Strategy 2021-2025		clarify the **expectation/vision** on "coordination" by the two organizationslist of alternative ways: regional joint teams; exchange of regional team members working temporarily in WOAH/FAO offices; increase direct involvement of RECs in regional teams activities; To be followed up
Recommendation 7	GS with the guidance of the the MC and PFP, to support harmonizatione of the risk communication for risk mitigation		GS working with colleagues at COM, MC, PFP and Regional Offices to review current risk

	measures across regions, and to propose regionally adapted mechanisms to provide technical and when possible logistic support for the implementation of recommendations on risk assessments, early warning systems in TADs-free and endemic countries, and development of strategies for priority TADs in infected countries to be completed by the end of the current Global Strategy 2021-2025;		communication (for risk mitigation measures) per regionon the basis of the first action item, to propose mechanisms of implementation of recommendations of the risk assessments and early warnings
Recommendation 8.a	8a MC and RSCs, considering the guidance from the PFP, to report by the end of the current Global Strategy 2021-2025 on their support for activities to: a. facilitate development and access to affordable diagnostic field tests including DIVA diagnostic tests, facilitate development and access to quality vaccines, including thermo-tolerant vaccines for PPR, and facilitate development of guidance and implementation of post vaccination monitoring.		GS to compile the list of activities being done across the GF-TADs on items mentioned under a. (diagnostics, access to quality vaccines and guidance on PVM) **and what they achieved**Then by reviewing the above, identify gaps and develop a proposal/action points for the consideration of GSC and MC to bridge the gaps.
Recommendation 8.b	8b. to relevant TADs prevention and control activities, Epidemiologic system characterisations and cross-border coordination among Members, and to report on specific technical and logistic support provided to countries whose endorsed official programmes or disease-free status are endangered		Identify and list activities done at national, regional and global levels (***need to be framed in the context of GF-TADs partners and related activities)***
Recommendation 8.c	c. political support to Rinderpest Secretariat with development and implementation of strategy to enforce WOAH Resolution 18/2011 and reduce the holdings of rinderpest virus containing materials held globally, ensure the availability of an emergency supply of vaccines, as the maintenance of diagnostic and surveillance capacity;		RP Sec to prepare what political support needed and GS to present this to the MC for their actions and support. ***(maybe the first thing is to report on what is done)***
Recommendation 9	GF-TADs partners, to develop by the end of the current Global Strategy 2021-2025, an approach to provide data for the indicators on efficiency of the coordination mechanism, in particular making links between national needs identified and the activities proposed, indicating activities' outreach, cost and investments.		By using M&E framework developed and existing M&E frameworks at FAO and WOAH, to map and link national needs to activities implemented ***I don't disagree but this is not operational - we need to discuss that***

Recommendation 10	Disease working groups, using existing Joint Workplan, to connect activities such as Roadmap meetings and Regional Advisory Groups (RAG) to RSCs and PFP to ensure cohesive action plans to progress with TADs prevention and control and when relevant, to reach disease official free status or disease freedom self-declaration.		Active usage of the joint work planregular update of the joint work plan sharing the joint work plan with PFP, RSCs and other relevant GF-TADs bodies***I think there is also a dimension of assessing/guiding the workplan to ensure they address the issue***
Recommendation 11	MC, with the support of the GS and the RSs, to report annually on organization, cost, and feedback/outcomes of multi-disease meetings.		List the multi-disease eventsGather info asked for ***[it requires defining how the informatoin is recroded by who)***Communicate the findings
Recommendation 12	MC is tasked with establishing the governing mechanism to monitor and facilitate the implementation of the HPAI strategy, as well as ensuring that the strategy's implementation roadmap is communicated by the time of the next Global Steering Committee meeting at the latest.		GS to support HPAI Taskforce in **defining goiverning mechanism in link with regions and** developing an action plan for the HPAI StrategyFinalize and communicate the implementation roadmap by the time of the next GSC meeting (in 2025)
Recommendation 13	The HPAI taskforce and RSCs, supported by the GS and RSs, to initiate dialogues on adapting the HPAI strategy to fit regional and subregional characteristics, and to formulate an aligned roadmap that reflects the specific needs of the Members within the regional needs.		